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OUT OF SIGHT OUT OF MIND

ABUSE AND NEGLECT IN THE COUNTY JAILS OF ARKANSAS

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The Politic

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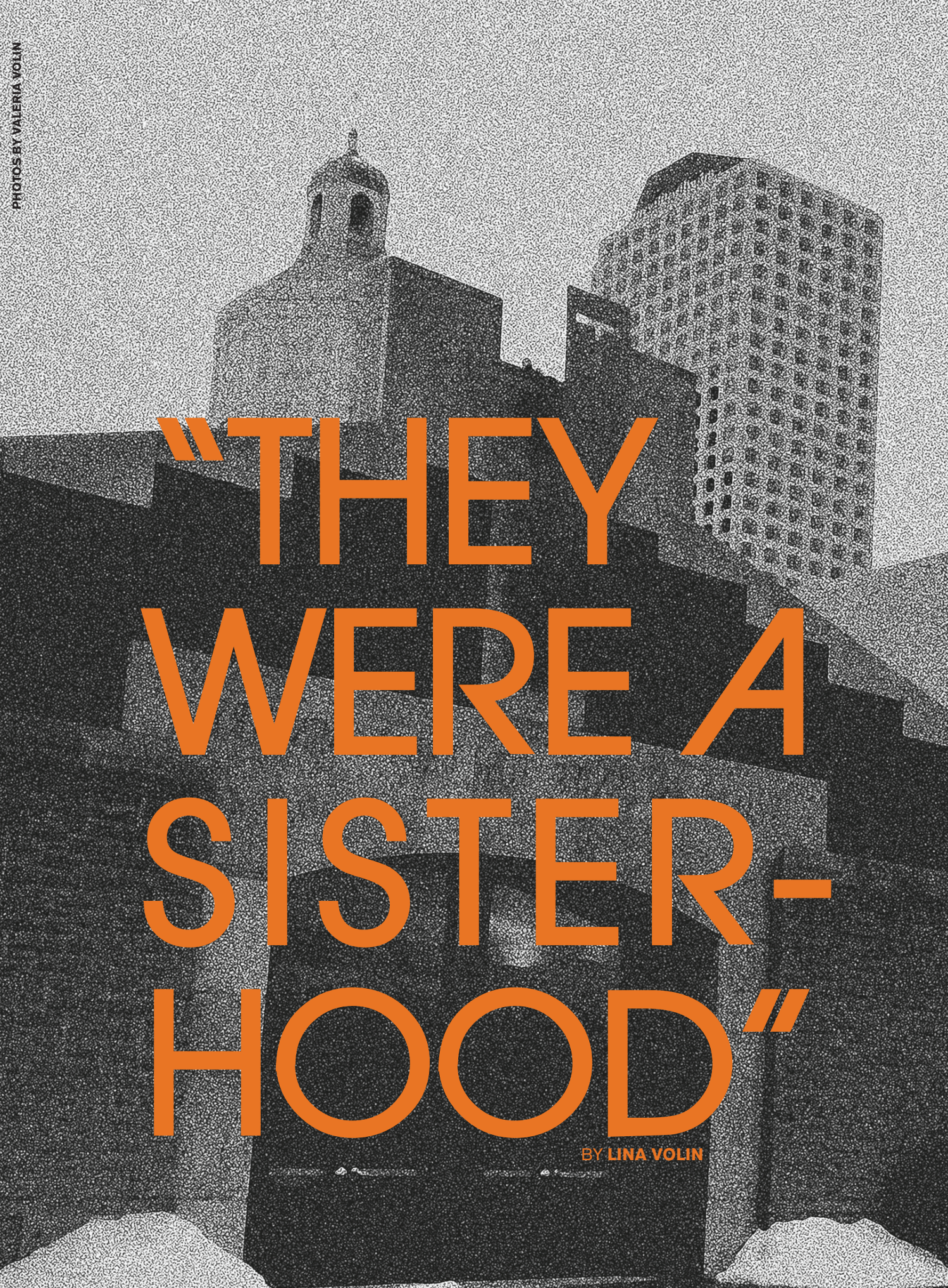
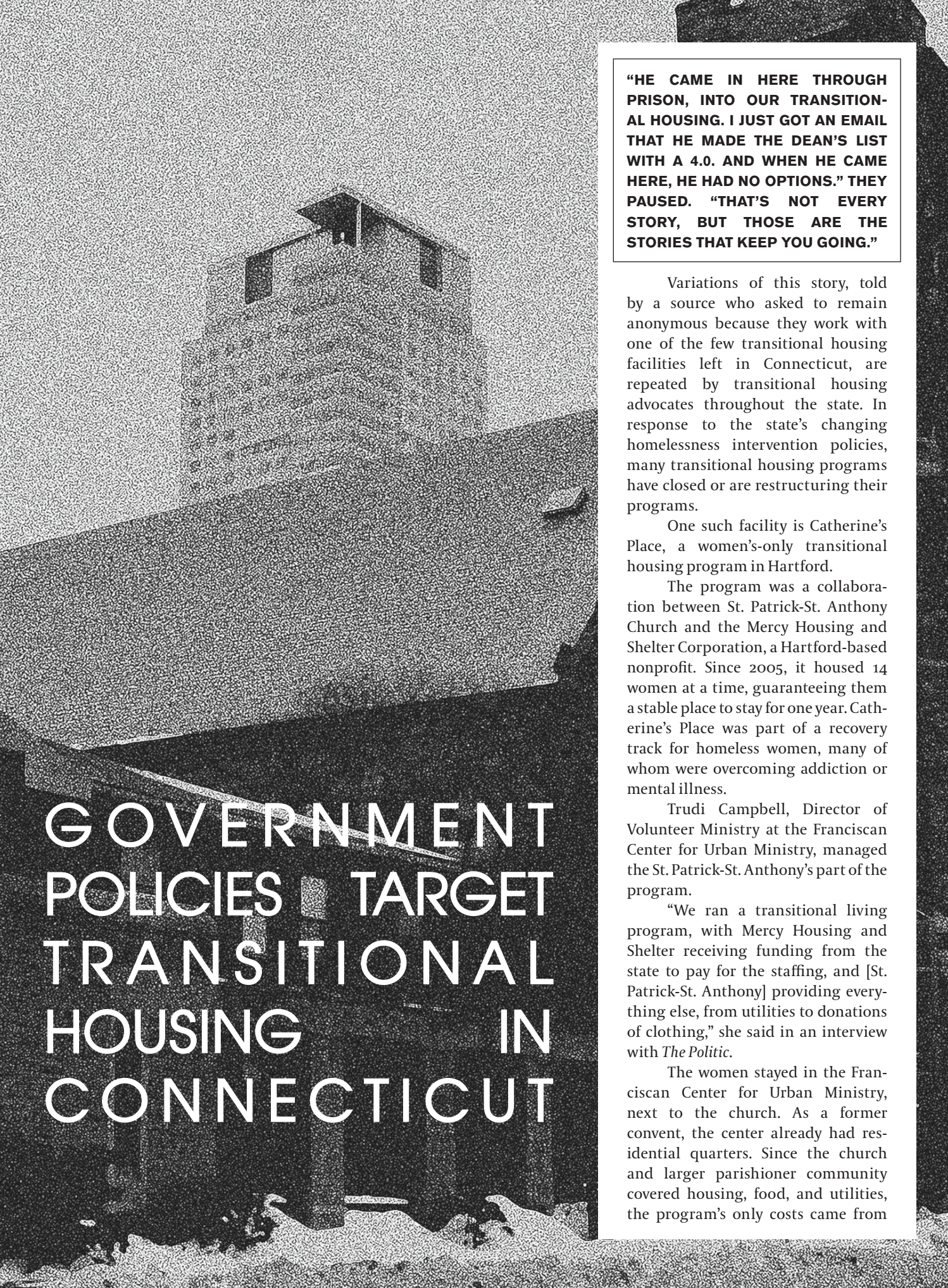


PHOTOS BY VALERIA VOLIN

"THEY WERE A SISTER-HOOD"

BY **LINA VOLIN**



GOVERNMENT POLICIES TARGET TRANSITIONAL HOUSING IN CONNECTICUT

"HE CAME IN HERE THROUGH PRISON, INTO OUR TRANSITIONAL HOUSING. I JUST GOT AN EMAIL THAT HE MADE THE DEAN'S LIST WITH A 4.0. AND WHEN HE CAME HERE, HE HAD NO OPTIONS." THEY PAUSED. "THAT'S NOT EVERY STORY, BUT THOSE ARE THE STORIES THAT KEEP YOU GOING."

Variations of this story, told by a source who asked to remain anonymous because they work with one of the few transitional housing facilities left in Connecticut, are repeated by transitional housing advocates throughout the state. In response to the state's changing homelessness intervention policies, many transitional housing programs have closed or are restructuring their programs.

One such facility is Catherine's Place, a women's-only transitional housing program in Hartford.

The program was a collaboration between St. Patrick-St. Anthony Church and the Mercy Housing and Shelter Corporation, a Hartford-based nonprofit. Since 2005, it housed 14 women at a time, guaranteeing them a stable place to stay for one year. Catherine's Place was part of a recovery track for homeless women, many of whom were overcoming addiction or mental illness.

Trudi Campbell, Director of Volunteer Ministry at the Franciscan Center for Urban Ministry, managed the St. Patrick-St. Anthony's part of the program.

"We ran a transitional living program, with Mercy Housing and Shelter receiving funding from the state to pay for the staffing, and [St. Patrick-St. Anthony] providing everything else, from utilities to donations of clothing," she said in an interview with *The Politic*.

The women stayed in the Franciscan Center for Urban Ministry, next to the church. As a former convent, the center already had residential quarters. Since the church and larger parishioner community covered housing, food, and utilities, the program's only costs came from

"THESE ARE WOMEN IN TRANSITION, TRYING TO MAKE THEIR LIVES BETTER. THEY REALLY WERE GIVEN THE RAW END OF THE DEAL. THEY DIDN'T HAVE ANY TIME TO MAKE PLANS."

their staff—caseworkers and recovery specialists with Mercy Housing and Shelter. When the state began redirecting funds from transitional housing to other homelessness intervention programs, the state funding—which paid for the staff—stopped.

"That's the whole reason the program closed," Campbell said. "There was no money left for staffing."

Last May, Catherine's Place left its location on Church Street and was folded into the existing 90-day program at St. Elizabeth's House, a shelter at Mercy Housing and Shelter.

THE STORY OF CATHERINE'S PLACE is a common one. States across the country have changed their strategies to respond to a growing body of homelessness research and ever-present budget cuts. National trends show a decrease in funding for transitional housing as funds are redirected toward other homelessness interventions like rapid re-housing.

Transitional housing is, by definition, temporary—most programs guarantee up to two years of housing in community settings, facilitating a recovery process that helps residents access the social services they need. The end goal is for residents to eventually find permanent housing and live independently.

"The idea is that during those two years, you'd get intensive assistance toward the factors that contributed to becoming homeless," said Josh Leopold, Senior Research Associate at the Urban Institute, in an interview with *The Politic*.

Rapid re-housing, on the other hand, offers immediate financial assistance to keep individuals from becoming homeless. In cases where the individual has already fallen into homelessness, the program works to quickly re-house them in permanent, independent housing within 90 days.

"The goal of [rapid re-housing] is to take individuals in a homeless situation that don't have any of the barriers of those who need permanent support housing and try to get [them] back into the community by providing short-term subsidies, so they can once again get back on their feet, manage their lives, get a job," Steve DiLella, Director of Individual and Community Support Programs at the Connecticut Department of Housing, told *The Politic*.

Lisa Bates, Executive Director of the Connecticut Coalition to End Homelessness, described the shift towards rapid re-housing.

"HUD moved largely away from transitional housing, and the state of Connecticut has followed the same research and followed suit to take that funding and use it for other types of programs," she said in an interview with *The Politic*.

The research Bates referred to includes the Family Options Study, a national study commissioned in 2015 by the Department of Housing and Urban Development (HUD). The study assessed four different types of interventions, two of which focused on transitional housing and community-based rapid re-housing. In the short-term outcomes report, the study found that transitional housing was more expensive and did not hold any tangible advantage over other interventions.

"That study, among others... showed that unfortunately transitional housing, which I think sounds like a good concept, just doesn't have the strong positive outcome that would justify the relatively expensive cost of such programs," Bates said.

Using the Family Options Study and similar findings from smaller studies, the Connecticut Department of Housing has shifted its attention to permanent supportive programs and rapid re-housing programs. While the former targets higher need households suffering from long histories of homelessness, the latter serves those in need of more temporary assistance.

"Essentially we have been able to be so successful because instead of managing homelessness, we're exiting people from homelessness," Evonne Klein, the Commissioner of the Connecticut Department of Housing, told *The Politic*.

For transitional housing advocates, the focus on immediate homelessness can obscure the advantages of transitional housing. Trudi Campbell, the volunteer director of Catherine's Place, voiced these concerns.

"The sense was that we weren't ending homelessness in Hartford and, by having transitional housing, it was more an idea that homelessness was being extended, not stopped," she said.

THE MOVE AWAY FROM TRANSI-tional housing came as a surprise to the St. Patrick-St. Anthony side of the program.

"Because we weren't involved in the funding, it wasn't something we'd known about," explained Campbell. The program came to a hasty and unexpected end.

"We were given two days' notice that they were moving out, and there would be no more program," she said. "These are women in transition, trying to make their lives better. They really were given the raw end of the deal. They didn't have any time to make plans."

Mercy Housing and Shelter, who was St. Patrick-St. Anthony's

partner in the administration of Catherine's Place, had advance notice of the program's uncertain future, according to Campbell.

"Apparently this had been in the works through the federal government for several years, the federal government was cutting back funds for transitional housing. The state of Connecticut and the housing agency knew about it for several years," she said.

Catherine's Place's sudden closure made for a difficult end to eleven years of close-knit community.

"[The women] weren't equipped and certainly weren't given what they were told they would have when they came into the program," said Campbell. "They were told they'd have a full year of housing and that they would have time to finish whatever training they needed."

The abrupt end came as a surprise to Joan Gallagher, former Associate Director of Programs at Mercy Housing and Shelter.

"I know it was just a huge challenge for the agency to try to figure out how we keep as many beds open as possible and still be able to provide decent services. I have no idea why it wasn't a better transition. That shocked me, when I had heard about that, because, SPSA and Mercy, I loved the relationship that we had," she said. "I think that because things were changing with a whole bunch of the transitional housing program slots at St. Elizabeth, they had to rethink everything."

Tenesha Grant, Director of Client Services at Mercy Housing and Shelter, described how the organization reacted to the lost funding.

"Our focus shifted to stay in alignment with any other initiatives that are going with the 90-day stay for the women," she told *The Politic*. "All the programming requirements from St. Patrick-St. Anthony are still the same, and they have a lot more services on site for them."

Within two days, Catherine's Place was folded into the 90-day program of the St. Elizabeth housing facility at Mercy Housing and Shelter.

TRANSITIONAL HOUSING PROGRAMS across the state reacted in various ways to the policy shift. Some, like Catherine's Place, closed down or were folded into another facility soon after funding stopped.

"There is a very small handful of [transitional housing] programs still operating with federal funding," said Bates. "What the future of those programs will hold is an interesting question."

The source who works with a still-open transitional housing program in Connecticut described the restructuring process.

"We don't know how [the shift] will impact it yet, because we've never done this," they said. "We're going to try the best we can to make sure it works for the men. First and foremost, that what's it's about. Some of it is exciting, this new model, some of it we're nervous about."

Some of the anxiety stems from shortening individuals' stay from two years to the 90 days common to rapid re-housing programs.

"We have men who say to us: 'We need some time to get ourselves back to where we were,'" they shared. "We just have to work harder with them. It's going to be on us...we had the luxury of time, and we will no longer have that."

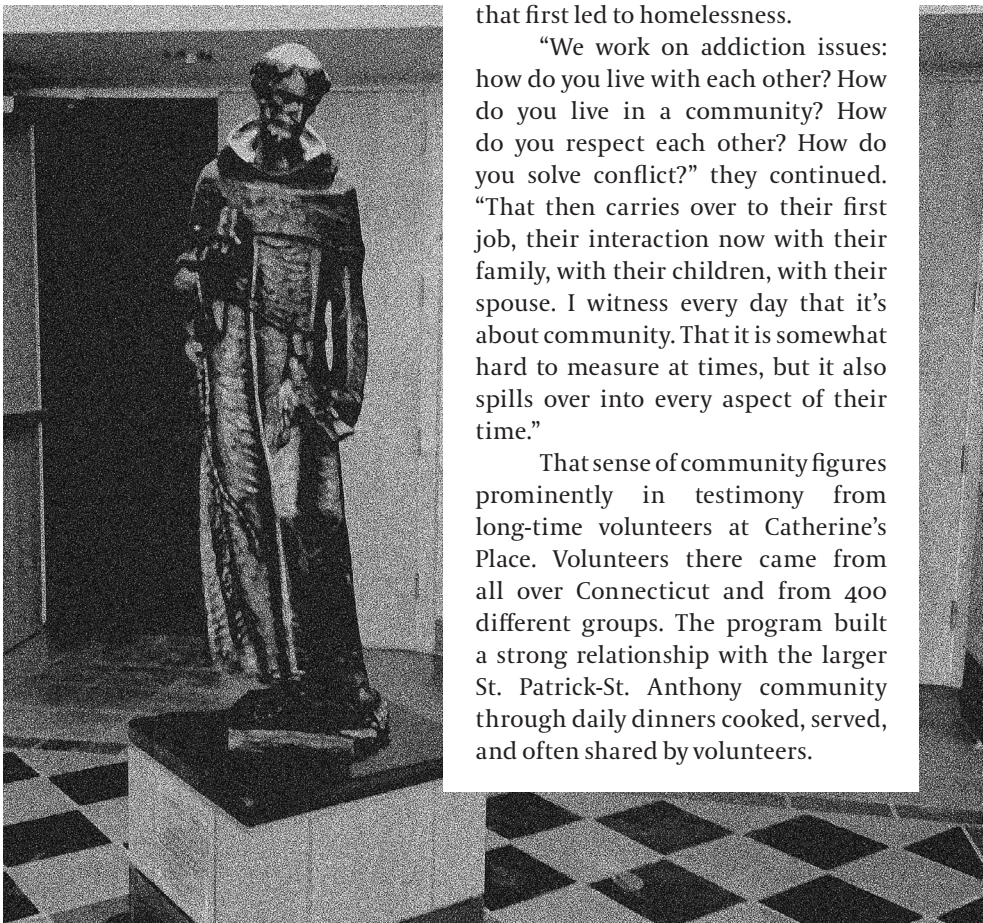
While those involved at the state level point to the many benefits of rapid re-housing in comparison to transitional housing, advocates of transitional housing highlight factors that are harder to quantify in studies—social services integrated with housing assistance and a strong sense of community.

"What I witness firsthand every day...[are] men who learn to live in a community. If you can live in a community with your peers, with staff, you're more likely to be a success when you go back to the world," said the source.

Integrating social services with housing aims to solve the problems that first led to homelessness.

"We work on addiction issues: how do you live with each other? How do you live in a community? How do you respect each other? How do you solve conflict?" they continued. "That then carries over to their first job, their interaction now with their family, with their children, with their spouse. I witness every day that it's about community. That it is somewhat hard to measure at times, but it also spills over into every aspect of their time."

That sense of community figures prominently in testimony from long-time volunteers at Catherine's Place. Volunteers there came from all over Connecticut and from 400 different groups. The program built a strong relationship with the larger St. Patrick-St. Anthony community through daily dinners cooked, served, and often shared by volunteers.



"It's what made this programming unique," Campbell said. "They sat down and ate dinner, family-style." This integrated the program into the wider community, bringing a range of people with different backgrounds into contact with each other.

"I cooked like I was cooking for my own family," said Fran Gilchrist, a St. Patrick-St. Anthony parishioner who volunteered at Catherine's Place for several years. "I remember a couple of times I was doing something else at the center, and I saw somebody making meals or bringing meals with children, and I thought: how great is that, to have children help you do this for someone less fortunate than yourself?"

Patti Hoppin, another dedicated Catherine's Place volunteer, also reflected on the many nights spent cooking and then sharing dinner with the women of Catherine's Place.

> "WE HAVE MEN WHO SAY TO US: 'WE NEED SOME TIME TO GET OURSELVES BACK TO WHERE WE WERE. IT'S GOING TO BE ON US... WE HAD THE LUXURY OF TIME, AND WE WILL NO LONGER HAVE THAT."

"It was encouraged by people who oversaw Catherine's Place, to create the relationship between resident and volunteer," she said. "I think it's really nice in thinking of it in the Catholic tradition of community and communion and baking bread."

In addition to daily family-style dinners, the evenings at Catherine's Place were free for activities that fostered the warm community that volunteers referenced. High school English teacher Karen Bing taught a memoir writing class there for three years.

"It started out as a way to give women a voice to express themselves, as a way to be seen," she told *The Politic*. "After a while, I started typing up what they wrote. We start a quilt, a story quilt. We hung a dowel and added pages to the story quilt and that hung in their common room."

The class did not seek to build writing skills for job opportunities but rather tried to build a community.

"The writing came from their heart," Bing remembered. "It ended up being more social interaction, a sharing. They would share what they felt through their writing. It was absolutely very loving, the way they interacted with each other. If somebody's writing was particularly sad, the others would pick them up and reassure them."

This community aspect of transitional housing is lost in rapid re-housing. Rapid re-housing programs do, however, facilitate some access to social services.

"In transitional housing, the idea is to offer to help someone in connecting with mental health resources, benefits they might be entitled to (like SNAP or Medicaid)," said Bates. "In rapid re-housing similarly, our goal is to help provide those connections, so clients can have additional supports they may need."

But Leopold reported there is typically not the same level of social services in rapid-rehousing as in transitional housing.

"With rapid re-housing, you're getting some kind of short-term assistance to live in your own rental housing, and you might see the case manager—who probably has between twenty and thirty differently individuals or families they're assisting—you might see them once a month," he said.

If community and supportive services distinguish transitional housing from rapid re-housing, then one of rapid re-housing's benefits is the stability it immediately offers.

"Rapid re-housing is a way we help people exit homelessness to housing that is there from the get go," said Bates. "If they want to stay there forever, they can."

"Rapid re-housing is a very modest and temporary subsidy to help people exit homelessness," she continued. "For many households, that is what they need."

She describes the idea of leaving homelessness to a lease that is owned not by a program but by the client as an important element of helping people find permanency in housing of their own.

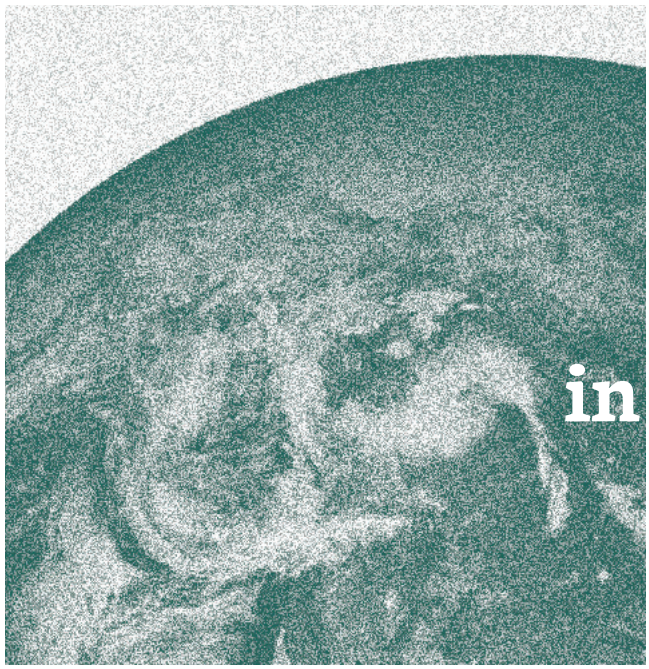
Weighing the benefits of community against those of permanency is a tricky balance. Since studies show that rapid re-housing and transitional housing have comparable success rates, the extent to which the state should consider more intangible factors like community is difficult to determine. But given the two interventions' similar success, rapid re-housing's lower expenses allow the state to serve more individuals with the same amount of funding.

"We don't want to fund programs just to fund programs. We want to fund programs that are effective," said DiLella.

CATHERINE'S PLACE LEFT ST. PAT-rick-St. Anthony last May. With it, the community of 14 women in various stages of recovery also disbanded. Writing teacher Karen Bing reflected on the strength of the community and the support its members got from each other.

"When we were together, there was an incredible sense of community, of support, that the women offered very freely to each other," she said. "They were there for each other. If somebody was down, there was always someone who was able to draw on their own experiences to help that person not feel isolated, not feel defeated, and to give them hope that they will eventually have the things that they want, which are what everyone wants. They want a safe place. They want their loved ones with them. They want to be loved. They want to have a job. And they were a sisterhood. They were a family."

DIPLOMACY FOR SALE: Internationally-Financed Lobbying in American Politics



BY **ARUN SHARMA**

IN DECEMBER 2016, PRESI-dent-elect Donald Trump called President Tsai Ing-wen of Taiwan. Their conversation was historic: for the first time since 1979, the leaders of the United States and Taiwan spoke directly. To some, Trump's call with Ing-wen suggested his possible recognition of Taiwanese sovereignty – and a break with decades of U.S. foreign policy.

A Wall Street Journal report identified an unexpected figure behind the call: former Republican presidential nominee and Senator Bob Dole (R-KS), who reportedly urged Trump's team to contact the Taiwanese leader. Dole now works as special counsel to the Washington firm that represents the Taipei Economic and Cultural Representative Office, Taiwan's unofficial embassy in the United States.

Trump's call raises the question of how internationally financed lobbying will influence the new administra

tion. Some worry that the president—accustomed to business dealings and inexperienced in foreign policy—may be too easily swayed by foreign leaders and their interests.

Taiwan is one of several small countries behind the bulk of internationally financed lobbying. Thomas Graham, a Senior Fellow at Yale's Jackson Institute for Global Affairs and Managing Director at Kissinger Associates, a consulting firm, explained this practice to *The Politic*.

"Many times you find smaller countries will hire lobbyists to get more access than simple representation. An individual has a reputation with a specific set of individuals," he said.

Small countries, Graham contends, often seek this access.

"In the State Department or elsewhere, people are busy. They are not necessarily going to deal with smaller countries. A lobbyist might have access to a level in the executive [office] where the information might make a difference," he continued.

The call with Trump is a high-profile example of this international lobbying. It immediately provoked concerns about how the Trump administration sets foreign policy. These concerns were exacerbated by reports that Trump did not contact the State Department before the phone call. Former Secretary of State John Kerry told the Saban Forum in Washington that Trump did not request talking points or recommendations.

Despite the call, Trump's position on Taiwan remains unclear. During a call with Chinese Premier Xi Jinping on February 8, Trump reaffirmed his commitment to the One China Policy. But this concession did little to assuage concerns about his foreign policy. To some, the Taiwan call was less a shift in policy than an amateur blunder.

Yet the potential for influence is not as clear as the Taiwan call might suggest. Some are skeptical of how much of a role Dole played in the meeting.

"He could have just recommended it. He could have helped set it up. But at the end of the day it is the White House who makes the decision to have the phone call," Graham said. In other words, the administration did not necessarily call Taiwan because of Dole's influence; he may have played a smaller role in the affair than reported.

This ambiguity makes it difficult to understand the precise role that lobbyists play. In matters both domestic and international, lobbyists represent any number of interests before govern-

Some worry that the president — accustomed to business dealings and inexperienced in foreign policy — may be susceptible to manipulation by foreign powers.

In matters both domestic and international, lobbyists represent any number of interests before government officials. While lobbyists must file reports on their actions, there are limits to what the public can know.

ment officials. While lobbyists must file reports on their actions, there are limits to what the public knows.

Despite its negative connotations, lobbying can also be an important tool for advocating policy changes, said Lara Chausow GRD '15, a political scientist who wrote her dissertation on political access in lobbying.

"Without lobbying, what we care about may not get on the agenda as easily," she said in an interview with *The Politic*. "If lawmakers aren't lobbied, are certain issues like LGBTQ rights really going to come up in their minds?"

Lobbyists do not only get issues on politicians' radars; they also help interest groups refine their messages.

"Access is a huge part of lobbying, but if you also have federal government experience and you leave, you have a lot more knowledge than someone who never had that experience," Chausow continued. "You can do a lot more in terms of strategy and access that people would otherwise never accomplish."

Graham defended the benefits of lobbying, even in an international context.

"Depending on the state lobbying and particular attitudes, American lobbyists might be given a hearing that foreign diplomats may not [get]," he said. "They have an understanding of what American national interests are, so foreign governments can receive more credibility."

But Virginia Canter, Executive Branch Ethics Counselor for Citizens for Responsibility and Ethics in Washington (CREW), warns of some potential dangers.

"Individuals are appointed or elected to represent the public's interest. The question is whether the special interests are crowding out the voice of the public," she said in an interview with *The Politic*. "Education about particular issues is not a bad thing. But we need to know. Is it just because people are making donations, making contributions, that they get a foot in the door?"

LEGISLATORS HAVE MANY STRATE-gies to make lobbyists more transparent and accountable.

According to Chausow, limiting money spent on lobbying would resolve some concerns about potential corruption. "But these limits just aren't going to be constitutional. What is one of the biggest issues is the fact that lobbying helps set the agenda for what gets dealt with," she said.

With more transparency, Chausow believes the public will be better able to determine what interests are determining the agenda. "If you don't have money to hire a lobbyist, then you have a hard time influencing the agenda," she said. "Then you don't give interested groups other, non-lobbying ways to get into the agenda. Transparency makes it possible to really grapple with this."

Current legislation requires federal lobbyists to register with the Clerk of the House of Representatives and the Secretary of the Senate. But this registration is only required if they spend more than 20 percent of their time lobbying—and only meetings with officials count towards that time. Consulting on government issues, providing lobbying strategy, or even arranging meetings does not count. This means that many lobbyists are not formally registered.

International lobbyists receive more scrutiny than domestic lobbyists. Since 1938, lobbyists for foreign governments have had to register with the federal government under the Foreign Agent Registration Act (FARA). Originally created to preempt the spread of Nazi propaganda during the Second World War, FARA now applies to several foreign entities.

After legislation, the most important restrictions on lobbying come from executive ethics rules. These rules vary from administration to administration, and their exact effects are often difficult to determine. The Obama administration had no major lobbying scandals.

The Trump administration, however, has made notable changes to these rules. Under the Obama administration, individuals could be granted permission to act outside of the rules put forth in the ethics commitment. This same policy holds for the Trump administration, but unlike under Obama, these waivers are not disclosed to the public.

Canter, who was also White House Ethics Counsel under Obama, described the stark contrast between these two policies.

Top Lobbying Firms in 2016
1. Akin, Gump et al
2. Brownstein, Hyatt et al
3. Podesta Group
4. Van Scoyoc Assoc
5. Holland & Knight
6. Squire Patton Boggs
7. BGR Group
8. Cornerstone Government Affairs
9. Capitol Counsel
10. K&L Gates

"Under the Obama pledge, these waivers were huge. They were only given when they were determined to be in the public interest," she told *The Politic*. "Under the new pledge, they've taken that standard out. These are completely discretionary, which is troubling. They've taken away much of the transparency that the public needs to hold officials accountable."

The Trump team also scrapped a requirement barring administration members from contacting their former departments for two years after leaving the White House. Instead, administration officials are now bound by current legislation, which restricts contact for only one year.

"This is important because law firms will carry someone for one year," Canter explained, "but not for two years." The omission of this provision from the Trump pledge has caused fears that the revolving door between public and private work will only move faster.

Even so, President Trump has enacted new rules. For example, he introduced a five year ban on all lobbying by former administration members as well as a permanent ban on any activity that requires administration officials to register under FARA. On the surface, this would appear to significantly curtail the influence of foreign governments.

But Canter believes there are lingering questions about the ban's efficacy.

"The weakness with this provision is that it is possible to register under the Lobbying Disclosure Act and then represent foreign entities under that vehicle. The other concern about this provision is that it doesn't really get at some of the largest concerns in terms of using public office for private gains," she explained.

Trump's administration has a notably high number of individuals who worked in the private sector — especially in industries they are now tasked with regulating. Rex Tillerson, for example, will make decisions as Secretary of State that impact the energy industry. Some view this as a cause for concern about his and others' ability to avoid conflicts of interest.

But according to Graham, there is little reason to consider past positions for future policy decisions.

"If the Russians have a more favorable view of Rex Tillerson because of his work with ExxonMobil, that may not mean that they gain any kind of benefit. It could, in fact, work to the advantage of the U.S. It is unclear why lobbying against sanctions should necessarily prejudice our views of him as Secretary of State," he said.

Canter remains skeptical of the public's ability to hold Trump officials accountable for their foreign dealings.

"People like Rex Tillerson and Gary Cohn are not going to make money lobbying foreign governments," she said. "They are going to make their money by using the relationships they will develop as government officials to make new deals for their old employers."

One of the most obvious ties to the private sector comes from the president himself. Trump resigned from the boards of several hundred companies shortly after his inauguration. But the Trump Organization is still owned by the president and managed by his two sons.

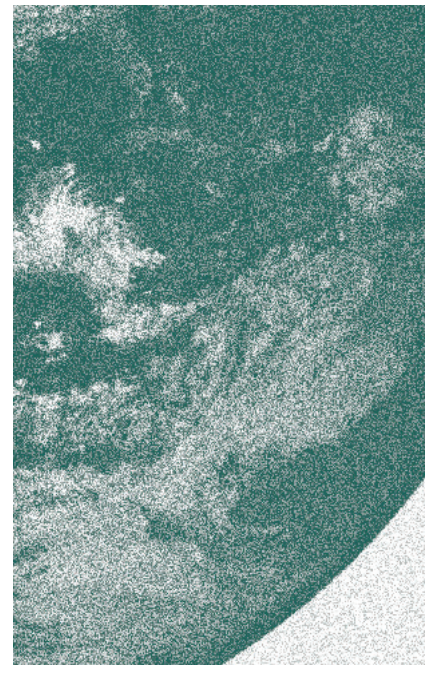
Canter's organization, CREW, is currently suing Trump because they contend that his ownership of the Trump Organization violates the Emoluments Clause, which states the president cannot receive gifts from a foreign government or entity. CREW contends this clause is violated when foreign government officials stay in Trump hotels and patronize the president's businesses.

While the lawsuit may not succeed, many remain wary of the potential for foreign influence through the Trump Organization.

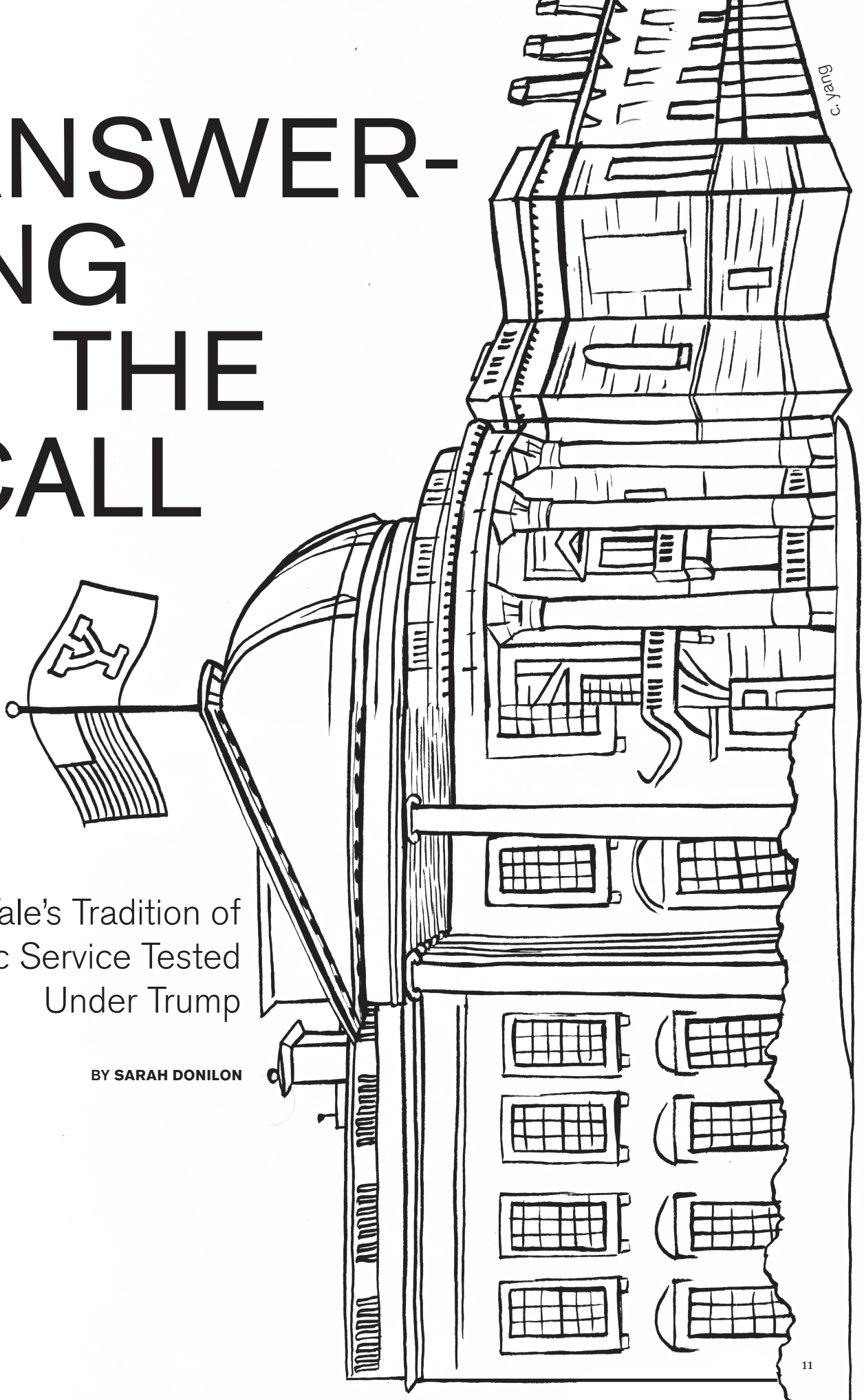
Graham shares these concerns.

"It is clear there are conflicts of interest. The president hasn't separated himself from the business. He still owns it and knows where many of his assets are. Those conflicts of interest create avenues that go outside of the normal lobbying and diplomatic channels."

As the Trump administration deals with potential conflicts of interest at the highest levels, it is clear that foreign lobbying is here to stay. With new rules taking force, however, it remains to be seen what impact international lobbyists will have. As President Trump makes foreign policy decisions, the question will continue to be: who is guiding his hand?



ANSWERING THE CALL



Yale's Tradition of Public Service Tested Under Trump

BY **SARAH DONILON**

IN NOVEMBER 1960, DAVID GERGEN '63, then a sophomore, stood on the New Haven Green to hear John F. Kennedy. In the last stretch of his presidential campaign against Richard Nixon, the senator had stopped for a rally in Connecticut. "[His speech] was fundamentally a call to service," Gergen, now a Harvard professor and political commentator, recalled in an interview with *The Politic*.

"This has to be a time for action for us," Kennedy told the crowd. "This is a contest between the comfortable and the concerned, and in my judgment, on Tuesday, the people of the United States are going to give us an opportunity to pick this country up and move it forward." Two days later, Kennedy was elected president.

More than fifty years after that speech, on Class Day in 2014, former Secretary of State John Kerry '66 addressed graduating seniors one street away from where Kennedy had stood. "Your education requires something more of you than serving yourself. It calls on you to give back, in whatever way you can. It requires you to serve the world around you and, yes, to make a difference."

"The core theme is that people with great privilege—it's the Spiderman theme—with great privilege and power comes great responsibility," said Harold Koh, Sterling Professor of International Law and former Dean of Yale Law School, who served as the State Department's legal adviser under Hillary Clinton, in an interview with *The Politic*.

But for some Yale students, the call to serve under the new administration might be unappealing. Before the election, there was scarce support on campus for Donald Trump. An October *Yale Daily News* survey found that 80.6 percent of students backed Clinton, while only 4.73 percent supported Trump.

That most students at Yale voted for a Democratic candidate is no surprise. There were similar levels of support for Barack Obama in 2008 and 2012 versions of that survey—81 and 80 percent. But even for a Republican candidate, Trump was unusually unpopular on campus: 12 percent of Yale students committed to vote for John McCain, and 15 percent for Mitt Romney. Last year, after the Yale College Republicans endorsed Trump, several board members resigned and founded the "New College Republicans," an anti-Trump conservative group.

Now, students interested in government but opposed to President Trump have to rethink their next steps.

"If you love the government that's in power, then it's a simple decision to say, 'I will serve in the public interest by working in the government," Koh said. "But when the government is somebody you didn't vote for and you still want to serve the public interest, you have to think about other ways to do that."

FROM GEORGE H.W. BUSH '48 TO Hillary Clinton LAW '73 to Samantha Power '92, Yale has a long tradition of public service. It is passed down through generations when freshmen sing Yale's fight song, "Bright College Years," and make the pledge: "For God, For Country, and For Yale." Students have no shortage of inspiration: Gergen noted that for a 32 year streak—in every national election from 1972 to 2004—either a presidential or vice presidential candidate had a Yale degree.

"Within a few hundred feet of my office at the White House, there were probably somewhere between five and ten Yalies," R. David Edelman '07, who most recently worked as an adviser for technology and economic policy at the White House, told *The Politic*.

What is it about Yale that encourages public service?

"In my view, Yale is one of those rare places where you can take incredibly bright, principled people who care deeply about ideas and help them think hard about turning those ideas into action," Jake Sullivan '98 LAW '03, senior policy advisor on the 2016 Clinton presidential campaign said in an interview with *The Politic*.

Sullivan, who also teaches a class at the law school, is one of many alumni in government who have returned to Yale, as professors or guest speakers, to encourage students to continue the school's tradition of public service.

"It's great having access to people who are actually doing things who can tell you what it's like," Sarah Siegel '19 told *The Politic*. Hearing Rhode Island Governor Gina Raimondo LAW '98 speak on campus prompted Siegel to apply for a Yale Women in Government fellowship and spend the summer in Providence working for her.

"She told us we have an obligation to give back," Siegel said.

David Thorne '66, former Ambassador to Italy, points to two reasons for his interest in public service: first, he lived in Europe after World War II because his father was a diplomat; and second, his closest friend at Yale, also the son of a diplomat, was John Kerry. After graduating in 1966, Thorne and Kerry both enlisted in the army.

Thorne described a mythology surrounding "Yalie men of action" that existed during the Vietnam War.

"There was a sense in our generation at that time of serving our country in the military. This was our war, and we were going to fight it," he said in an interview with *The Politic*.

The same spirit of service is memorialized on Yale's campus. Jon Finer LAW '09, former State Department Chief of Staff, told *The Politic*, "When you're there, you see history all around you because it's preserved in the buildings and portraits on the walls."

Jay Carney '87, White House

Press Secretary under Obama, developed an interest in local politics in New Haven, including a union strike. "It was very interesting in terms of getting engaged in on the ground politics and issues that affect people directly instead of just political theory or grand strategy," he said in an interview with *The Politic*.

For Eddie Fishman '11, a career diplomat who served on the State Department's policy planning staff under Kerry, it was Yale's history department that sparked an interest in government. Fishman credits the department with encouraging previous generations of public servants, too, under some of the same mentors like professors John Gaddis, Don Kagan, and Paul Kennedy.

"I think there's this notion of the scholar-statesman—folks who loved reading history and understanding how great leaders and diplomats made decisions in the past, and then trying to apply those lessons to the real world," he told *The Politic*.

But in the Trump era, is Yale preparing students for government jobs they no longer want?

"The next four years are not going to be easy to navigate in the public sector," Thorne said. Nevertheless, Thorne and every other alum who spoke with *The Politic* stressed the important work that the federal government does—no matter who is president.

Part of the distinction is between political appointees and Foreign Service officers or civil servants who stay in government through several administrations under different political parties. The 4,000 political appointees in government at any one time are outnumbered by 2.79 million civil servants and 13,000 Foreign Service officers.

"I don't think you should automatically reject working in a Trump administration in a civil service kind of role because you don't agree with its policies," Nate Loewentheil '07 LAW '13, who worked on the National Economic Council under President Obama, told *The Politic*. "I think you should be more nuanced and attentive to the specifics."

"Even if you are not serving a political role, you can—just through sheer competence and energy and passion for the work—make an impact," Katharine Gallogly '12, who most recently worked on education issues on the White House Domestic Council, echoed in an interview with *The Politic*.

While students might want to stay away from Washington, they might also be able to restrain policies that they oppose if they are in government.

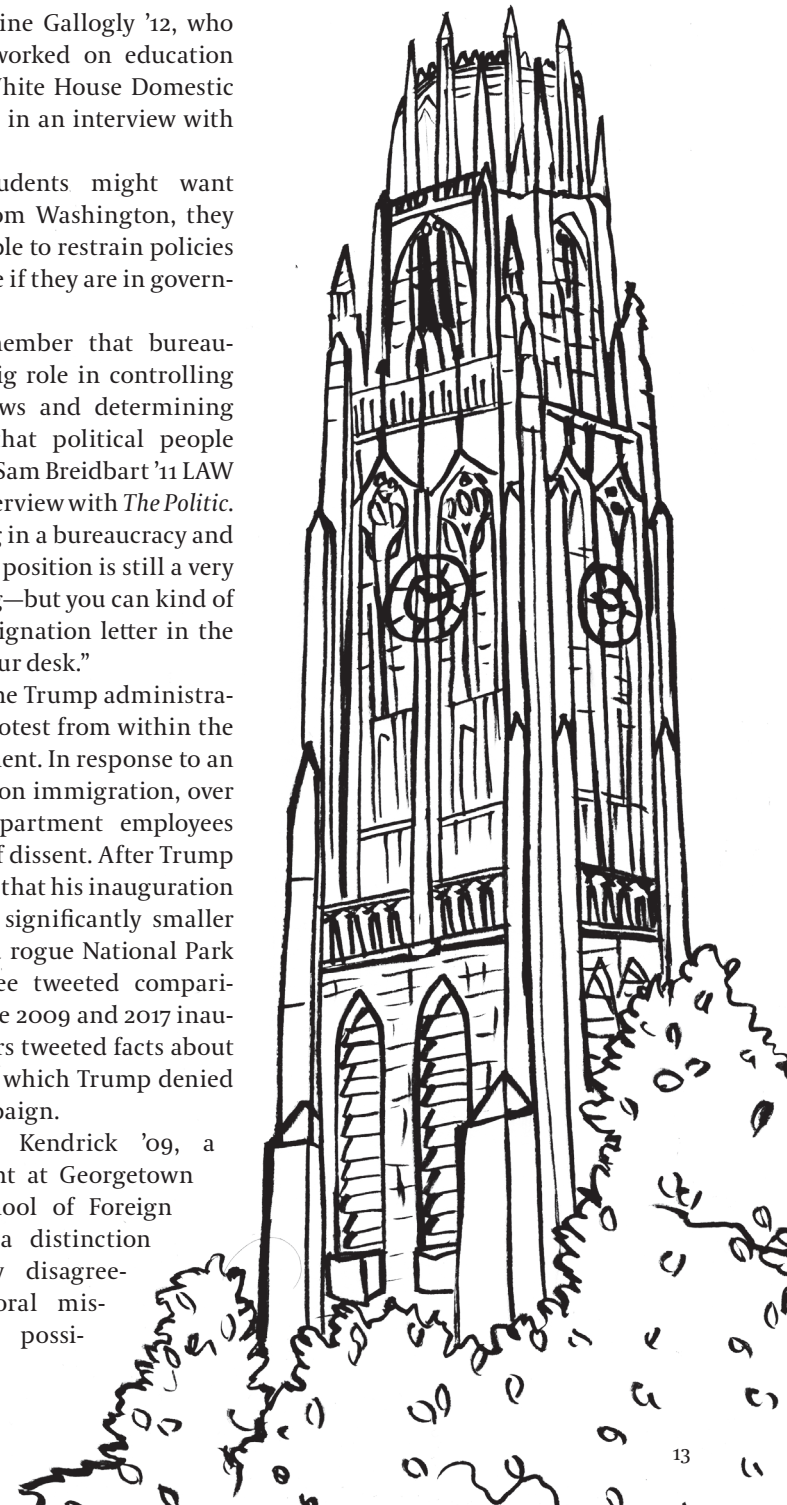
"Let's remember that bureaucracies play a big role in controlling information flows and determining the decisions that political people actually make," Sam Breidbart '11 LAW '19 said in an interview with *The Politic*. "And so working in a bureaucracy and in a civil service position is still a very important thing—but you can kind of work with a resignation letter in the top drawer of your desk."

Already, the Trump administration has seen protest from within the federal government. In response to an executive order on immigration, over 1,000 State Department employees signed a letter of dissent. After Trump disputed claims that his inauguration crowd size was significantly smaller than Obama's, a rogue National Park Service employee tweeted comparison photos of the 2009 and 2017 inaugurations. Others tweeted facts about climate change, which Trump denied during the campaign.

Katharine Kendrick '09, a graduate student at Georgetown University's School of Foreign Service, made a distinction between policy disagreements and moral misgivings. One possi-

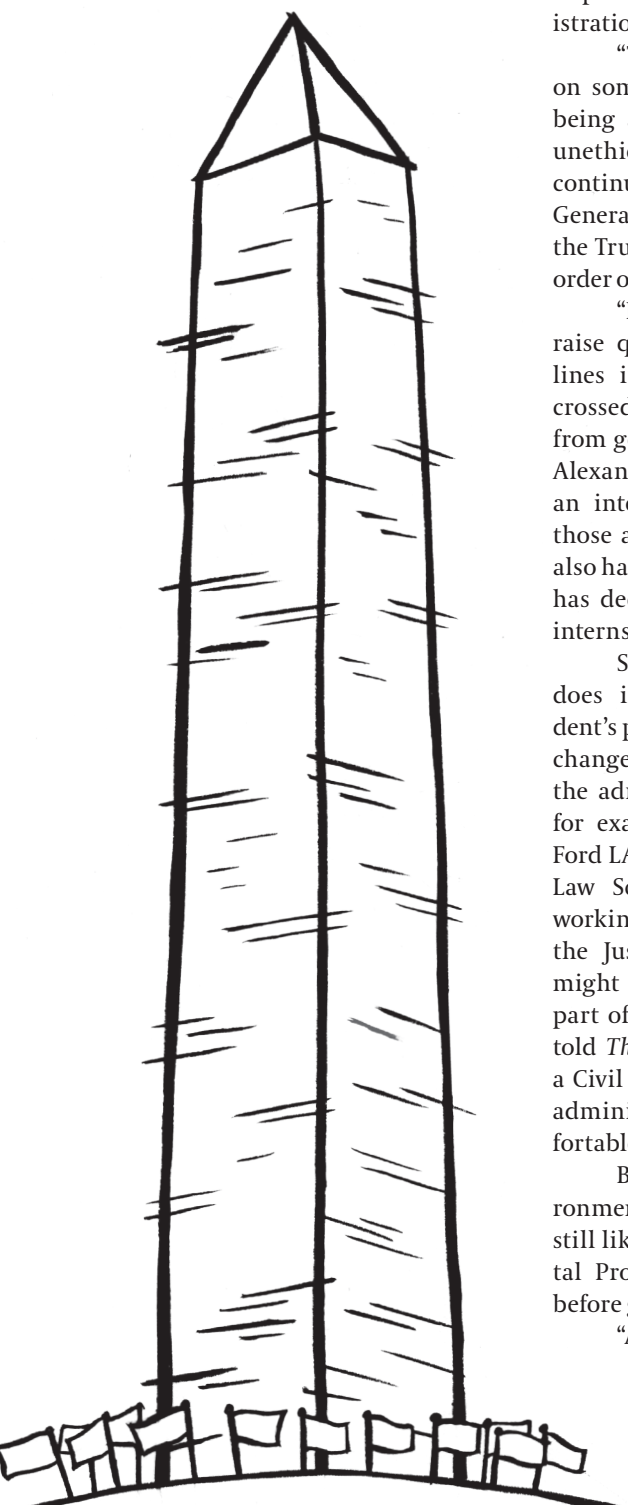
"I don't think anyone here has political ambitions because they're some sort of evil, maniacal person. They all want to do good, almost like a savior complex. "

Karl Notturno, '17



"If there's a silver lining in this period, it's that people are being forced to broaden their vision of public service."

Harold Koh



bility, she said, is "working within government and realiz- ing that at some point you may need to work on policies you disagree with—and that has been a question for bureaucrats under every administration." In his first government job, Koh, who is a Democrat, clerked for a Republican judge. He later worked in the Justice Department under the Reagan administration.

"That's different from working on something where you feel you're being asked to do something that's unethical or unprincipled," Kendrick continued. When, as Acting Attorney General, Sally Yates refused to enforce the Trump administration's executive order on immigration, she lost her job.

"I think people have started to raise questions of what are the red lines in government that would if crossed would deter an individual from going into government service," Alexandra Francis LAW '18 agreed in an interview with *The Politic*. "And those are certainly conversations I've also had with myself," she said. Francis has decided to accept a government internship this summer.

Some work the government does is distanced from the president's policies, but other departments change drastically depending on the administration. That is the case, for example, of the place Christina Ford LAW '18, co-president of the Yale Law School Democrats, dreams of working: the Civil Rights Division of the Justice Department. While she might consider working in another part of the federal government, Ford told *The Politic*, "I would not go into a Civil Rights Division in the current administration. I wouldn't feel comfortable working for Jeff Sessions."

But Eva Albalghiti '17, an Environmental Engineering major, would still like to intern at the Environmental Protection Agency this summer before going to graduate school.

"A summer internship would be a really great way for me to start to understand a little bit more about how this administration works," she told *The Politic*.

Emil Friedman '20, who has interned for Senator Chuck Schumer, is definitely not going to work in a Trump White House, though he has given some thought to an internship in the Department of Education.

"But that's going to take a lot of deep thinking about whether that's a group of people I want to be involved with," he said in an interview with *The Politic*.

"I understand those concerns, and I think they're justified in some ways," Fishman said. "The thing I'd say, though, is that public service is about serving the United States of America first and foremost—it's not about any specific person or political figure, it's about the good of the country."

Carney emphasized the value of making change from within the government.

"The system is where lives can be changed or stopped and regulations can be rewritten and ultimately governance can change," he said in an interview with *The Politic*.

Trump has had some tension with federal agencies. One of his first actions as president was implementing a hiring freeze to reduce the number of federal workers in an effort to cut expenses. The president has also criticized the intelligence community, mostly made up of civil servants.

On top of that, Lily Sawyer-Kaplan '17, a White House intern during the Obama administration, remarked in an interview with *The Politic*, "Given the fact that the administration is a mess at the highest level, I can't imagine they have a particularly well-organized internship program."

Students uninterested in the federal government might consider returning home to work at the state or local level. "I would argue that the rebuilding of local communities is

the best way to respond to the kind of crisis we see at the federal level," Gergen said.

Dasia Moore '18, a native of North Carolina, feels a pull back to the South.

"Before the election, I had thought returning South was something that could wait until after I had attended law school and lived in 'exciting places' like D.C. and New York as a young adult," she wrote in an email to *The Politic*. Now Moore still plans to go to law school but feels an urgency to travel home.

Breidbart, who previously worked in the New York Mayor's office, is happy that more Yale students are planning to work in local and state government. On the other hand, he said, "It's also a frightening thing. You don't want to have a brain drain from the civil service in Washington."

Other Yale alumni interested in politics turn to journalism.

Michelle Hackman '15 is a reporter at the *The Wall Street Journal* who wrote for the *Yale Daily News*. Hackman told *The Politic* she used to think to herself, "This is one of the biggest service-minded schools in the country, and I'm spending all this time doing this self-serving thing of building up my journalism career by working at the YDN." But over time, she said, "it slowly dawned on me that what I was doing was public service." As a city reporter, Hackman attended New Haven town halls, visited state legislators, and wrote about state laws. Now she specializes in health care policy.

Some students have held off on deciding their career plans.

"I have to have a longer time horizon to work for the federal government now," Ford said. She hopes that after finishing law school and her clerkship, the government will be different.

Sawyer-Kaplan had hoped to return to Washington to work in the Clinton administration after graduation.

"Obviously, my dream would have been to work in the Clinton administration or do something central to their priorities, likely women and family issues," she said.

Instead, she has decided to go straight to law school. "The election just clarified for me that we need a lot of people who have the tools to work on social justice issues. And we need good lawyers especially."

"If there's a silver lining in this period, it's that people are being forced to broaden their vision of public service," Koh said.

Recent alumni have charted public service paths outside of government. Jason Green LAW '08 started a production company that sponsors community-based documentary films, and a technology company that matches individuals to jobs and training based on their skills. Kendrick advises travel company Airbnb on China policy. Gallogly is going to do a fellowship in New York City to encourage civics education.

When he graduated from law school in 2003, Sullivan remembers declining interest among law students in working under George W. Bush. At that time, his classmates had to find other ways to get involved.

"But that's the thing about students at Yale," he said, "they're creative and they find those outlets and I'm confident the same thing will happen now under Trump."

ON NOVEMBER 4TH, 2008, HUNDREDS of students flooded onto Old Campus chanting, "Yes, we did." Some of them started singing the national anthem.

"It was a real civic celebration," Breidbart said. He had traveled with a big group to New Hampshire with the Yale College Democrats to campaign for then-Senator Obama. Finer, who graduated in 2009, felt public service was "very much in the bloodstream while I was there." Gallogly had worked on the campaign before arriving to campus as a freshman, so "that night felt very personal." Green spent most of his third year of law school as the National Voter Registration Director for the campaign. "That election was an activation for young people," he said.

There may have also been something about Obama's message that appealed to Yale students in particular. "More than just the fact that [Obama] preached a kind of civic mindedness that is attractive to young people, there was also an appreciation of expertise and being somebody who can command a policy area and can evaluate big data—these were the ideas of the moment," Breidbart said.

Now, he continued, "Beyond the politics having changed, there's just less demand for that kind of expertise."

Sawyer-Kaplan worries that Trump's message will make the White House less inclusive than it was under Obama. "My internship office was an incredible swath of young Americans, and I think that this administration has made it very clear -that it only sees a certain type of American as valued or worthy of this administration's attention," she said.

But some Yale students hope to work in a Trump administration. Karl Notturno '17 is Yale's most vocal Trump supporter. For months, he has publicly defended Trump online and has offered to meet with students to discuss his views. He told *The Politic* he finds Trump inspiring, mostly because he feels the country is on the brink of a "golden age of business." Notturno said that he and his friends who supported Trump have applied to work in the administration.

Notturno is not sure he will get a job, or how useful he would be if he does. "I'm not sure there's anything I can substantively do for them that they would need me for, and I don't

expect to be rewarded for my support," he said. "If there's something I can do, or those other people can do, we'll go for it."

Notturno pointed to the overwhelming support for Clinton among Yale students: "That isn't particularly reflective of the rest of the country." Though the national electorate was much more evenly split than the Yale student body, Clinton did carry a convincing majority of young votes—55 percent to Trump's 37 percent.

With so many Yale alumni working in government and journalism, Notturno believes that many people in Washington have a shared perspective. "When I listen to people talk here about certain policies, there's a very mainstream line in Yale, I see also played out in what you would consider the mainstream media—CNN, things like that. I hear the same things echoed," he said. "And it makes sense to me because a lot of the career politicians, a lot of the establishment politicians, a lot of the media personalities they're referencing, all these people have come from Yale."

Still, the Trump administration is not without Yale alumni. Three members of Trump's cabinet have degrees from Yale: Treasury Secretary Steven Mnuchin '85, Housing and Urban Development Secretary Dr. Ben Carson '73, and Commerce Secretary Wilbur Ross '59. Stephen Schwarzman '69, who made a 150 million dollar donation to renovate Commons, now renamed the Schwarzman Center, is one of Trump's economic policy advisers.

"I'm not a fan of the notion that our government leaders shouldn't come from our great national institutions," Koh said.

"The fact of the matter is that Yale itself, the undergraduate population, draws from all over the world, and many people who are coming here are the first person from their family to leave home," he continued.

Loewentheil believes the most important qualities in a public servant are not educational background but competence and passion. "I think you could come from Yale and be an excellent civil servant and you could be from any other school in the country and be a terrible public servant. Or vice versa," he said.

"I don't think anyone here has political ambitions because they're some sort of evil, maniacal person," Notturno said. "They all want to do good, almost like a savior complex. But they also think that they just know vastly more than everyone else in the world."

"THE IRONY IS THAT DONALD TRUMP may do something that Hillary Clinton couldn't do, that Bernie Sanders couldn't do, and not even Barack Obama could do, and that is to create a progressive movement that inspires your generation," Gergen said.

Sullivan has found a new energy among his students that didn't exist several years ago. "What's interesting is that while students are less certain about how they want to make a difference, they're actually more passionate about making a difference than they were before the election."

The first question students ask him is how they can be useful while Trump is president. "I preach the gospel of running for office to anyone who will listen," Sullivan said. He believes a major problem is that good people are deterred from seeking public office. To address that problem, Yale Law Women recently started a campaign to send postcards to women at the law school asking them to run for office.

Since the election, students have mobilized: the Yale College Democrats are writing testimony to support progressive bills in the Connecticut legislature; Dwight Hall, Yale's umbrella community service organization, has started "Fired Up Friday" advocacy sessions; law students are leading the charge to allow refugees to enter the country.

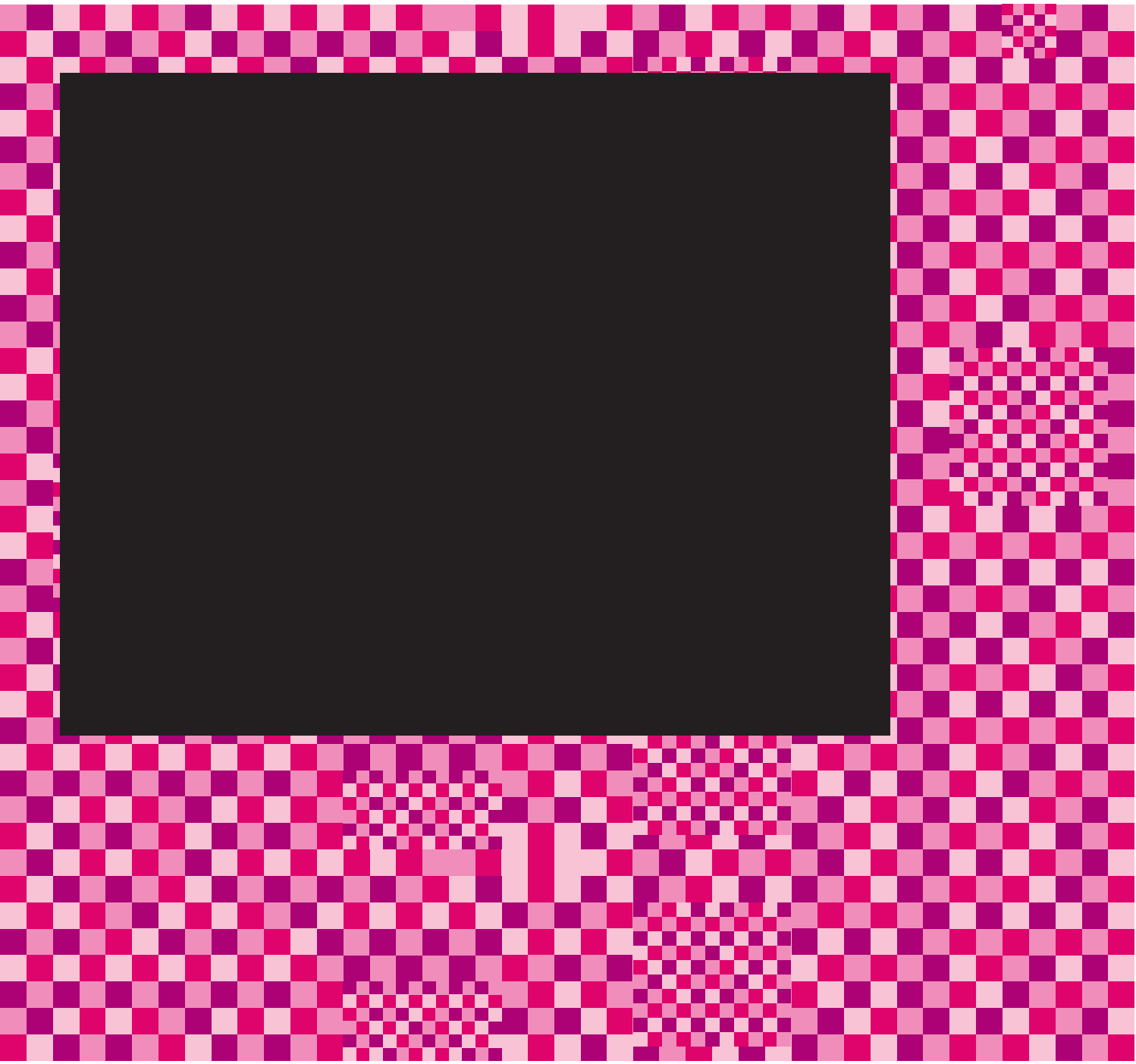
"I'm constantly amazed by, over the years as a teacher here, how students leave Yale and they think it's expected of them to make a quick and important impact," Koh reflected.

For many Yale students, the call to serve has changed. No longer a message of hope and change, it is one of duty and urgency.

"I think that Trump definitely solidified exactly—whether I like it or not—I have a responsibility in terms of my job after graduating," Daniel Vernick '19, who last year won a seat on his local town hall in Massachusetts, told *The Politic*. "I definitely want to work on the Elizabeth Warren 2020 campaign—and that is decided."

Sitting on Old Campus, seniors in the class of 2014 heard a message from John Kerry familiar to Yale students: "The four years you have spent here are an introduction to responsibility." Despite the changing circumstances, that same spirit has remained from his time at Yale to today.

As the Trump administration begins, students are reevaluating how best to fulfill that responsibility. About a year away from her own graduation from Yale, Moore said, "I'm thinking differently about how to use my education for the most good as the challenges 'good' is up against keep changing."



BY **KEERTHANA ANNAMANENI**

"I DON'T THINK THE LEADERS OF THE mainstream current feminist movement would consider anyone who is pro-life to be a feminist," Emily Reinwald '16 told *The Politic*.

In Reinwald's view, the Women's March, the most visible expression of the current feminist movement, also excluded pro-life women.

"I don't think most pro-life women felt comfortable attending," she said.

The Women's March was a global feminist protest on January 21, 2017, the day after Donald Trump's inauguration. Its broad agenda featured a call for "open access to safe, legal, affordable abortion and birth control for all people, regardless of income, location or education." But this explicitly pro-choice language was contested by pro-life advocates who also opposed Trump.

In the days before the March, the organizers clarified in a statement that their "platform is pro-choice" and "has been since day one."

"We look forward to marching on behalf of individuals who share this view," the organizers stated.

In keeping with their platform, organizers retracted the partnership

status for New Wave Feminists, an anti-abortion organization, two days before the March, calling the initial decision to allow their official partnership "a mistake."

Linda Sarsour, one of the Women's March organizers, said the platform is deliberately broad—including sections on disability, and workers and immigrant rights—and the March was open to everyone, even if they don't agree with every part of its mission.

"Being pro-life is a political view, it's not an oppressive force. So the pro-life stance does not have room in feminism and certainly not today's wave of feminism."

"We don't believe a quarter million people will see themselves in every platform," Sarsour said in an interview with The Washington Post. "We are not a pro-abortion march; we are a pro-women march."

But more and more women who opposed abortion demanded to be officially included in the Women's March on Washington. Their pushback raised questions about what exactly makes a "feminist."

Can—and should—the fight for gender equality accommodate women who don't support abortion?

According to Margaret Homans, Professor of Women's, Gender, and Sexuality Studies at Yale, reproductive justice is a core tenet of 21st-century feminism.

"If you identify as pro-life, I don't think you can simultaneously identify as a feminist. Intersectional feminism is about finding the connections between different modes of oppression. Being pro-life is a political view, it's not an oppressive force. So the pro-life stance does not have room in feminism and certainly not today's wave of feminism," she said in an interview with *The Politic*.

To Homans, the issue is not complicated: the Women's March was right to exclude pro-life women.

But other pro-choice women point to the hypocrisy of a feminist movement that claims inclusivity but has no room for pro-life women.

Sriya Nuguri, a freshman at Babson College, made a conscious choice not to attend the Women's March.

"I'm an Indian woman. I'm pro-choice. I'm able-bodied, I'm cisgender, I'm receiving a college education. The march was for me, but I don't know if that is everyone's experience," Nuguri said. "Frankly, I don't know if I have time for a movement that is going to claim to be for everyone and be blatantly hypocritical."

Feminist scholars note that these issues have historical roots. According to Ziv Eisenberg, who teaches the seminar Reproductive Health, Gender, and Power in the United States at Yale, the movement's opposition to divergent viewpoints stems from the legacy of the Second Wave Feminism of the 1970s.

"Second-wave feminists saw all women as an oppressed class, and considered themselves the avant-garde that would liberate women from the shackles of their false consciousness. For these activists, being a woman meant being a feminist and a supporter of women's reproductive rights," Eisenberg said in an interview with *The Politic*.

"From their stand, it was difficult to accept that some women did not agree with feminist ideology," he continued. "This was feminists' biggest mistake, and one we still live with. Even today, people who believe that it is a woman's right to choose find it hard to understand how come a woman, any woman, would oppose the legality of a woman's right to terminate her pregnancy."

Tina Whittington, Executive Vice President of Students for Life for America, a national pro-life organization that supports anti-abortion students across the country, argues that a woman's ability to reproduce is vital to her womanhood.

"I do not want to be equal to a man. I want to have equal rights to a man, but I have different biological abilities than him," she said in an interview with *The Politic*. "My friend says, 'A woman has three superpowers: the abilities to ovulate, gestate, and lactate,' and I agree. I don't want to suppress my ability to produce a child, or pretend that it isn't central to my power as a woman."

Changing gender norms and destigmatizing abortion, Whittington believes, would only devalue a woman's reproductive abilities.

Even so, Whittington and other members of Students for Life decided to attend the Women's March on Washington.

"I identify as a feminist, and I was excited to be part of what seemed like a historical movement," she said.

The signs they carried at the March asserted that caring for all women's well-being includes opposing abortions. Abortion, according to Students for Life, condones violence against women and fetuses, causes emotional and physical suffering, and devalues motherhood. They argued that that to oppose abortions is to both challenge

"My friend says, 'a woman has three superpowers—the abilities to ovulate, gestate, and lactate,' and I agree. I don't want to suppress my ability to produce a child, or pretend that it isn't central to my power as a woman."

and embrace feminism.

After facing derogatory comments and even violence, Whittington and her colleagues said they felt unwelcome at the March.

"People tore up our signs, tried to kick us. Some even spit on us and cursed us out," Whittington said.

Her aversion to the March also stems from what she called "crude" representations of female reproductive organs.

"I have never seen so many pussies in my life. It was ridiculous to watch women who hated Trump's vulgar comments about female body parts simultaneously fight that vulgarity with even more vulgarity," she said. "I hated having my son next to me, seeing this many vaginas and pussies and boobs. I am more than my reproductive organs, and I did not understand why they were being overrepresented."

Some pro-choice women like Vicki Beizer '18, Public Relations Coordinator for the Yale Women's Center, also expressed qualms about the overwhelming representation of female reproductive organs, but for different reasons.

"Yeah, some women get power from reclaiming these organs, but it is important to realize that not every woman has those parts," Beizer said in an interview with *The Politic*. "Womanhood is not about having those parts, and while we can enjoy 'pussy' hats all we want, there's more to the equation that we have to consider."

Other pro-choice women commented that the March was lacking in certain ways, but still called it an overwhelming success.

"Even while I recognized that trans women could have been excluded and the march could have been even more inclusive, we have made such strides with inclusivity," said Homans. "This is the most inclusive march I have ever attended, and quite possibly the most inclusive march of all time. I wanted its success so badly, so I hesitate to dismiss the entire march on account of a few problematic features."

To other staunch supporters of the March, recognizing the movement's ideological bent is crucial to understanding the values of those who marched.

"I believe that it is more important to understand the millions of people who marched in Washington, as well as other cities across the country, as an ideological group with a partisan bent," Eisenberg said. "The initial drive for these demonstrations may have come from individual women and ended up under the label 'Women's March,' but ultimately, we are talking about people who voted in the last election for Democrats. These marches were a direct response to the election of Donald Trump, whose behavior the marchers abhor."

"This is the most inclusive march I have ever attended, and quite possibly the most inclusive march of all times. I wanted its success so badly, so I hesitate to dismiss the entire march on account of a few problematic features."

Others believe the disconnect between pro-life and pro-choice feminism centers around the issue of when life begins.

"I'm pretty sure we can all agree that killing a child is wrong. We just don't agree on when the life of a child begins," said Reinwald. "Pro-choice people don't think they are advocating for killing children, since they believe that an unborn child in the early stages of development isn't yet a child. Obviously, I disagree with that and believe life begins at conception."

As long as the conflict between pro-life and pro-choice women boils down to one seemingly simple question—when does life begin?—no answer can sufficiently encompass both views. And as the Women's March demonstrated, modern, mainstream feminism remains divided along the fault lines of abortion.

OUT OF SIGHT OUT OF MIND

ABUSE AND NEGLECT IN THE COUNTY JAILS OF ARKANSAS

BY OLIVIA PASCHAL

THERE ISN'T MUCH

TO THE TOWN OF WALNUT RIDGE, THE SEAT OF LAWRENCE COUNTY IN northeastern Arkansas. You have to drive about a hundred miles on old Rock 'n' Roll Highway 67, through towns like Minturn (population 107) and Alicia (population 121) to get there. Its only claim to fame is that the Beatles once changed planes at the regional airport in 1964—which it commemorates with an Abbey Road mural, a Beatles' Guitar Walk, and an annual Beatles on the Ridge festival. Other than that, the town has a drugstore, a couple of churches, acres of farmland, and the county courthouse, which houses the county jail.

I first visited Walnut Ridge last summer when Seeds of Liberation, the nonprofit I was working for, was asked to speak with an inmate at the jail. When I arrived at the run-down courthouse, it was pretty clear the heels I had brought along wouldn't be necessary. It was pouring rain that day, so I waded through the parking lot in dress pants and sandals and asked the secretary at the court office for directions to the jail. She led me down a dim hallway to a room with 1970s-style paneling and a receptionist in a T-shirt advertising the local high school football team. A few minutes later, I was sitting in what amounted to a computer closet around a tiny table with Scott Archer.

Archer has been in and out of the county jail and state prison for several years. His convictions, mostly on drug-related charges and failure to pay fines and fees, combined with his status as a low-level sex offender, have hurt his ability to find employment.

He has been held in the Lawrence County Jail on four separate occasions while waiting for trial, he later told me—once for a day, once for a week, once for two months, and once for six months. The facility has 42 beds, but it is consistently overcrowded, forcing inmates to sleep in the hallway or on the floor.

"In Lawrence County, from the time you're put in there, it's at least forty days before you get to go to court," he told me. "A lot of places will have court once a week, but they only have court there like once every five weeks. If you're lucky, you'll get on the first docket, but usually you get on the second or third docket. So if you can't make bail, you're there for four or five months."

When I visited Archer last summer, he was in the middle of one of his months-long stints at the jail.

His family's neighbor, Cindy Parke, had asked us to meet with him to look into rumors that the jail was dirty and crowded and that the guards weren't all that nice. When Parke and Archer's family visited him in jail, he told them shocking stories of how guards and staff were mistreating him and other inmates. The most egregious incident occurred only days before I first visited him.

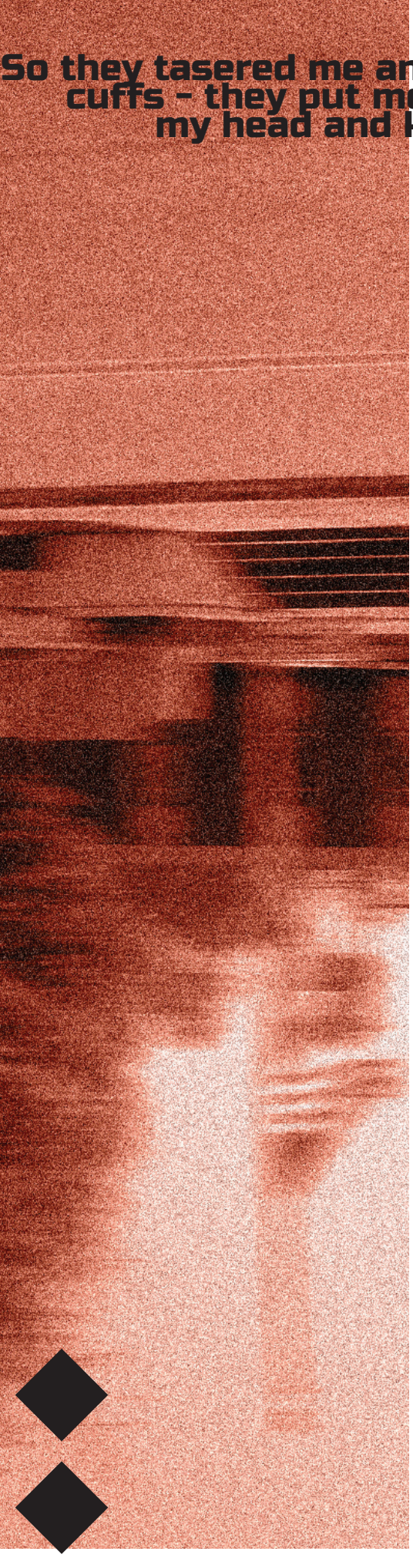
"I was being disruptive—it was lights out and I kept making noises," Archer said. "They came back and told me to be quiet, and I didn't, and they came back and was going to put me in isolation and I didn't want to go. So they tasered me and put me in what they call a chair—it looks like a wheelchair with handcuffs – they put me in that and restrained me and put me in the shower, and put a football helmet on my head and kept hitting it until I'd be quiet."

And that wasn't all. Archer had been fighting a toothache for a while, he said, and had requested to see a dentist.

"I put several applications in to get to the dentist and they never would," he said. "They kept telling me I had an appointment and they would never get me to the doctor."

The toothache worsened. Sitting in the visiting room at the jail with me, he reached back into his mouth and pulled out a tooth. It had rotted clean through. I asked if he'd shown that to the guards or the jail staff. He had. They

**So they tasered me and put me in what they call a chair—it lo
cuffs - they put me in that and restrained me and put me
my head and kept hitting it until I'd be quiet."**



had done nothing, he said, and still refused him medical attention. As Archer finished his story, he gingerly placed the rotten tooth back into his gums.

"There was an incident with one guy where he was a hemophiliac, he bled a lot," he added. "They mixed up the medicine they gave him. They gave him aspirin that made his blood thinner, and he started bleeding. They wound up having to take him to the emergency room." Jail staff, rather than medical professionals, handle the distribution of medication in the jail.

This incident wasn't the most egregious. Archer told me that another inmate was supposed to be receiving treatment for a serious mental illness. The man's prescription had run out, and Archer thought the jail staff were dragging their feet to renew his medicine. Instead, the guards reportedly told the inmate they would place him in solitary confinement until he "recovered" from a breakdown.

This isn't the first time the Lawrence County Jail has been accused of impropriety since its founding in 1965. Citing insufficient staff and chronic overcrowding, jail inspection reports over the last twelve years have consistently referred to the jail as "dangerous." According to the inspections, several employees had not received a basic jail training course. A 2013 letter from the Criminal Detention Facilities Review Committee asked the county Quorum Court and the County Judge to tour the facility "to familiarize themselves with the liability they carry as a county governing body."

In 2014, the Arkansas Jail Standards Board voted unanimously to order the county to close the jail by September of that year and transfer its inmates to facilities in other counties. But due to a legal loophole, the jail did not close. The Quorum Court instead decided to build a new jail funded by a half-cent sales tax increase, which voters approved that year. Ground broke on the new facility in January 2016 — almost a year and a half after the original jail was deemed unsafe — but it has yet to open. The county has said, tentatively, that construction will finish in January 2018.

Meanwhile, Lawrence County's inmates, many of whom cannot afford to post bail or to pay the overdue fines that landed them in jail, sit in cramped, overcrowded cells. Archer says they are allowed outside only once or twice a week—if they're lucky.

The jail received two more damning inspections in 2015 and 2016.

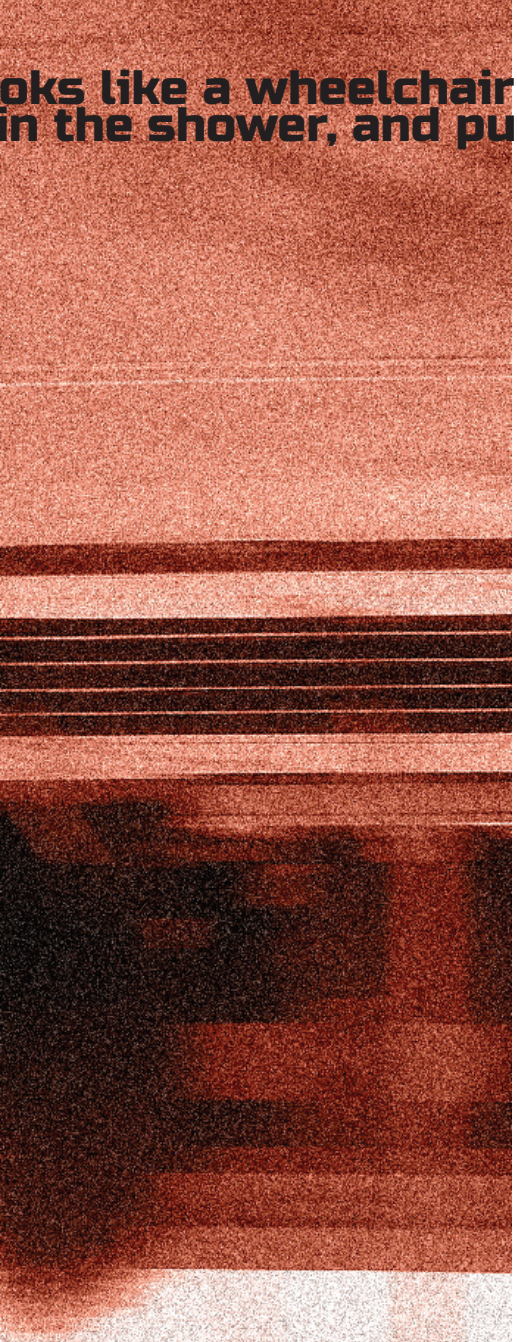
In Arkansas, there are 28 judicial districts, each with its own jail review committee. At least once a year, the committee visits each facility and reviews it based on minimum standards published by the state.

"There were two inspections while I was [in Lawrence County Jail]," said Archer. "People walked through and inspected it. I don't really know what they were looking for, but the days prior to that the staff did a lot of moving stuff out of the kitchen and painting and cleaning."

The many failed inspections and attempted closure of the jail were due to the 40-year-old building's structural deficiencies, not because of the jail's practice of mistreating its inmates.

Community efforts to hold officials accountable for keeping the current facility in passable condition have proven fruitless. Over the last several months, Parke—a resident of neighboring town Imboden—has been in constant contact with state and local officials trying to understand why the jail has not yet closed, or why the county has neglected to provide its inmates adequate medical care. Her efforts have gotten nowhere.

She and I both filed federal Department of Justice complaints against the jail and its staff with the Special Litigation Section of the Civil Rights Division. Though we each received a response promising that the



department would look further into the matter, seven months later, there has been no change. Parke's inquiries to state legislative offices have also come up empty. The Lawrence County Jail Administrator and the Lawrence County Sheriff's Office did not return multiple requests to comment for this article.

THE PROBLEMS THAT HAVE

surfaced in Lawrence County Jail don't seem confined to that facility. A former employee at the Benton County Jail, on the other side of the state in northwest Arkansas, who agreed to speak with me on condition of anonymity, described similar practices there. The jail serves a much larger and wealthier county than Lawrence County, and its inmate population consistently hovers around 500.

"Many inmates don't get the proper medication in jail; for example, no inmates are allowed medication for ADD," the former staffer said in an email. "Inmates that were suicidal or of unsteady mental health were 'thrown in the hole'—put in solitary confinement—which made little sense to me of how this was supposed to improve mental health."

In a highly publicized case in 2012, the jail settled a million-dollar lawsuit in which a female inmate, Faith Whitcomb, died from pancreatic cancer there after being refused any medical treatment except Tylenol for months. According to local media, the inmate's family believes that one of the reasons she was refused medical treatment was because she suffered from severe mental illness.

Parke thinks there is pressure to keep arrests and the inmate population high in Lawrence County in part to generate revenue for the county. In Arkansas, counties are responsible for funding and maintaining their jails— a task that generally falls to the Quorum Court of each county.

In areas like rural Lawrence County, where the poverty rate is nearly 24 percent, steady streams of revenue can be hard to secure. Fines and fees charged to inmates by the county courthouse can make up a sizable portion of the budget for cash-strapped counties. In Benton County, inmates must pay a fee to set up a medical appointment. Arkansas counties can charge fees for anything, from filing required paperwork to an inmate's use of a public defender, which is a constitutional right.

Yet the jails in both Lawrence and Benton Counties remain understaffed. The former employee of the Benton County Jail thinks this has more to do with what the county prioritizes in its budget-making than it does with a lack of funding.

"While officers were getting brand new Tahoes to replace mildly worn ones, and using those cars for personal use (instances of using them on vacation, one as far as Florida), many aspects of the jail were neglected," they said. "Understaffed jail guards were constantly busy and missing critical dates and details. I remember finding an inmate in our system that was supposed to have been released days prior to when I found him still sitting in our jail, simply because of either overwork or little attention to detail." A spokesperson for the Benton County Jail could not be reached for comment.

Archer also attributes some of the problems at Lawrence County to issues with the county budget.

"I think they [the guards] are underpaid," he said. "If we were lucky, we [went outside] one time a week for an hour. Their excuse for that was that they were undermanned, didn't have the staff."

The lack of adequate staffing at the Benton County jail has caused

"Inmates and former inmates experience what is termed 'civil death,' where many of their citizenship rights are revoked,"

issues for both inmates and their families, said the former staffer.

"Late visitations and late releases occur. Particularly, the deputies in booking have too many responsibilities and inmates for the number of staff," they said. "It was not uncommon to have loved ones of someone arrested call and call all day, unsure of what was going on, simply because the staff had not had time to properly update the computers with inmate information."

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES across Arkansas have faced scrutiny after a slew of lawsuits that allege inmate mistreatment much like what Archer described at Lawrence County. A 2015 article in Al Jazeera America entitled "What's the Matter With Arkansas?" details similar incidents of abuse at county jails and prisons across the state. Since January 2016, there have been 887 cases filed in federal court challenging the conditions of incarceration facilities in Arkansas. Experts and government officials alike generally trace this phenomenon to overcrowding, an issue that has been exacerbated by a state law passed in 2013 making it harder for inmates to be released on parole and easier for those out on parole to be reincarcerated.

Parke said that since she started asking around about the Lawrence County Jail, former inmates have reached out to her about the facility's conditions.

"I continue to have people contact me weekly with complaints, both in past years and present, because I am asking," she said.

To even bring a case to court can be difficult for people who are incarcerated—the federal Prison Litigation Reform Act, passed in 1996, prohibits inmates from bringing cases regarding prison conditions to court unless "such administrative remedies as are available are exhausted."

Because prisons and jails themselves are in direct control of these "administrative remedies," it can be nearly impossible for an inmate to satisfy this requirement and get standing in court. Archer and several other inmates with whom I was in contact last summer did not pursue legal action because of this requirement.

Nevertheless, there are some signs of progress. Over the last few years, several county jails across the state have voluntarily closed, and six new facilities have opened. Several other counties have begun new construction, or are remodeling or expanding their current facilities.

Counties and jail examiners hope that this will alleviate some of the overcrowding issues. But while these improvements might make a difference in inmates' long-term standard of living, there has still been no concerted effort to address inmate abuse or lack of medical care.

Lisa Corrigan, an assistant professor of communication and director of the Gender Studies Program at the University of Arkansas, and the author of Prison Power: How Prison Influenced the Movement for Black Liberation, said that once someone has been convicted of a felony, political institutions become significantly less likely to respond to their concerns—which makes it difficult to advocate for better jail conditions or more funding.

"Inmates and former inmates experience what is termed 'civil death,' where many of their citizenship rights are revoked," she said. "Beyond employment and educational penalties is the fact that felons can't vote, which means that their perspectives on the justice system aren't part of its reform or abolition."

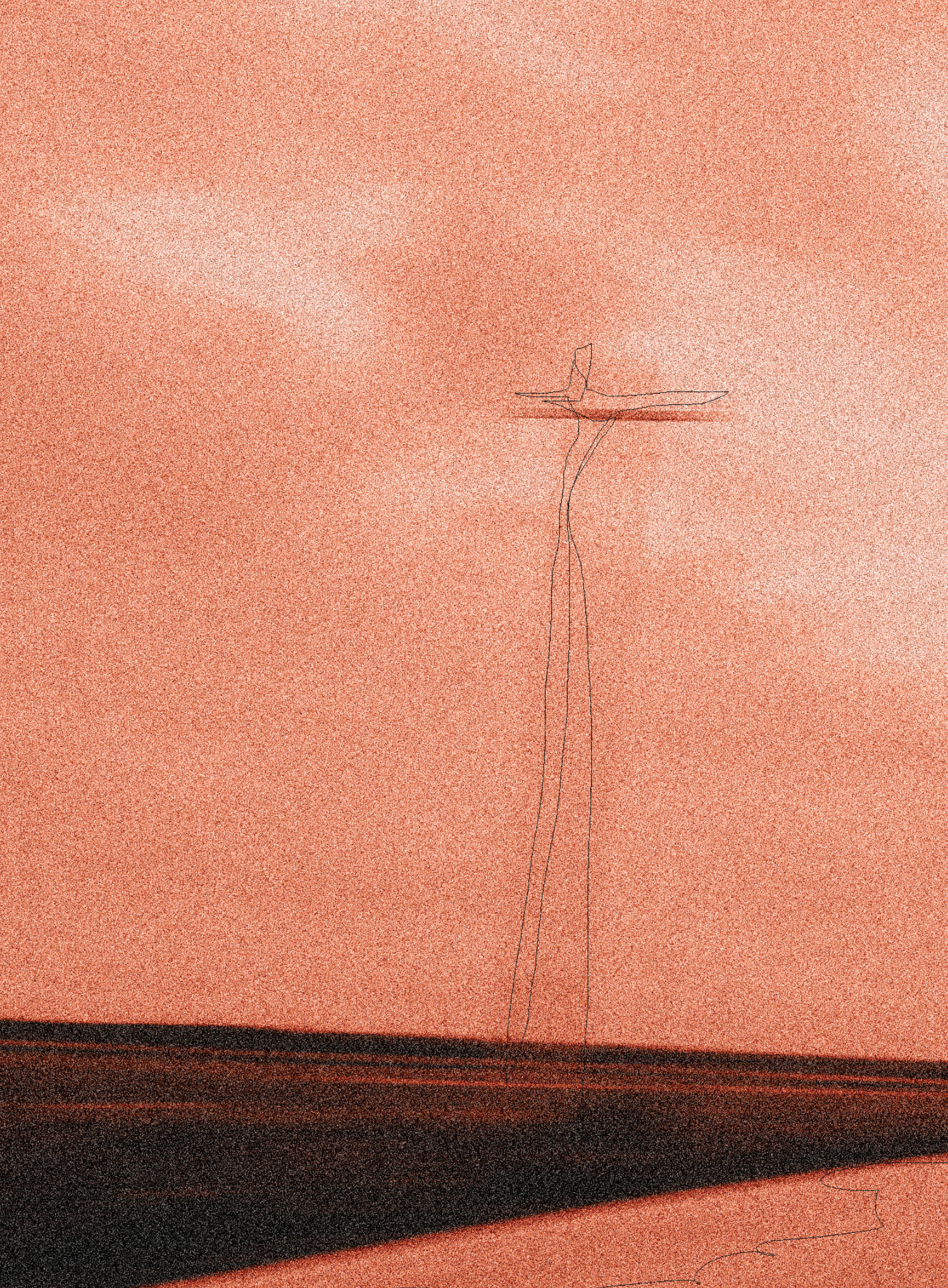
These obstacles—along with the localized nature of county jail policy—make it difficult to advocate for broader jail reforms or highlight the conduct of jail staff. Corrigan also attributes the lack of public attention focused on this issue to the American mindset.

"From an administrative perspective, transparency has been the overwhelming challenge for accountability [regarding the safety of inmates]," she said. "From an ideological perspective, it has been the American penchant for retributive justice instead of restorative justice."

Americans, she thinks, are less likely to be concerned about the rights of individuals with criminal records because they are viewed as more deserving of punishment—even if the abuse occurs in jails before they have gone to trial, when people are still presumed innocent.

But the eerily similar environments at Lawrence County Jail and Benton County Jail — facilities over 240 miles apart — indicate a widespread, institutionalized system of civil rights violations at jails across Arkansas. For former inmates like Archer—who has since moved out of the state to find work—it is too late to undo the lasting physical and mental effects of the abuse sustained during incarceration. For others, it might not be. But, said Parke, state and county officials need to start taking these problems seriously.

"Can you tell I am angry? Yes, I am. I am also very hurt that our elected officials, especially those in law enforcement would allow these things to occur on their watch. They are the stewards of public trust, and should be accountable to a higher standard of behavior," she wrote in her complaint to the Department of Justice. "I say these prisoners deserve to be treated like human beings. A little dignity can go a long way."



Liberals Like Christ: A Progressive Eva

BY **MEHR NADEEM**
PHOTOS BY **FELICIA CHANG**

"I DON'T LIKE BUMPER stickers," Ray Dubuque told me. He makes a little rectangle with his hands. "What, they must be like 11 inches wide! I'd have to kneel down right next to the boot of a car to even get a look at that!" He chuckles to himself a little, then tells me, "That's absolutely not how I do it."

Ray opts for something far larger than a bumper sticker. Attached to the back of his car is a trailer with signs that read "Liberals Like Christ" and "Jesus Would Be Furious." Between these words is a line of pictures of Martin Luther King Jr., Barack Obama, Elizabeth Warren, Frederick Douglass, and Jesus. If that doesn't draw enough attention, the bellowing voice of Ray's pre-recorded sermons might.

The photos of Jesus next to liberal historical figures first seemed odd. To some, "progressive evangelical" might sound like an oxymoron. And, statistically, most evangelical Christians don't vote for Democrats. According to the Pew Research Center, in the 2016 presidential election over 81 percent of evangelicals voted for Donald Trump.

"I don't buy the 81 percent of evangelical number cited constantly by pundits," said David Swartz, associate professor of history at Asbury University and author of Moral Minority: The Evangelical Left in an Age of Conservatism. "That number does not count black evangelicals, Latino evangelicals, and the millions of evangelical immigrants from Africa and Asia—all of whom resonate theologically with white evangelicals." This group typically agrees with evangelicals on core issues like abortion and LGBTQ rights—which have historically aligned the evangelical bloc with the political right—but they often vote for Democrats.

I had seen Ray's car around Yale's campus frequently, so I reached out to him to understand what he means by "Liberals Like Christ."

Ray looked nothing like I imagined. Though he was much taller than my five-foot-almost-four self, I had imagined him even bigger and perhaps more brooding.

In a voice much softer than his bullhorn, he asked, "Are you Meyher?" Sticking my hand out, I thought about correcting his pronunciation of my name, but before I could, he said gently, "That sounds like Mayor. You should just call yourself Mayor, that's a very important position here!" I couldn't help but return his smile.

Ray settled into the leather chair inside the common room of Grace Hopper College to start the interview. Born in Chicago and raised in a "very Catholic" Franco-American family,

ngelical Makes the Case Against Trump

"Jesus did not talk about abortion or gay marriage. What he did talk about was divorce, and this president is on his third wife"

he became interested in the Catholic Church at age 10 because he admired a priest at his parish. Though Ray is unable to remember his name, he defined his memory of this priest by his "unusual involvement and concern with social issues."

After attending seminaries in the East Coast for twelve years, an experience he described as his "tour of America," Ray joined the Roman Catholic church as a priest.

But he soon became disenchanted with the Catholic priesthood.

"It wasn't long from when I started that my dream of becoming a priest became a nightmare," he said. "I didn't find what I expected in the priesthood. What I found was that the higher up that I went into the hierarchy, the more corruption and dishonesty and hypocrisy that I found."

After three years, Ray left the Catholic Church and became a United Methodist priest. That was when he met his wife, Jane. Ray choked up as he spoke of Jane's illness and treatment at Yale-New Haven Hospital. In 2015, after 45 years of marriage to Ray, Jane died. He told me about her love for social work that led them to adopt five disabled children over the course of their marriage. When asked why they chose to adopt, he answered: "The world is overpopulated as it is, and there are so many children in need."

Ray considers Jane's dedication to social issues a core Christian value—one that, he says, aligns best with liberal ideals. But not all Christians agree.

One of the key issues that has maintained evangelical support for the Republican Party has been abortion. Swartz believes that Hillary Clinton's pro-choice position might have lost her the election.

"Many evangelicals preferred Clinton to Trump on immigration, health care, diplomacy, and nearly every other issue. But since abortion rates are so high and are seen as such a life-and-death issue, some felt like they had no choice, despite the uniquely repugnant candidacy of Trump," he explained.

Elizabeth Bruenig, an editor at The Washington Post and a prominent Christian leftist, echoed Swartz's ideas.

"They were concerned about long standing evangelical issues: abortion, which they perceived Clinton as especially zealous about, religious liberty, and rhetorical deference to Christianity in government," she said. "While Trump didn't really bother with even appearing personally committed to any of that, he went through the motions with various evangelical leaders, and won endorsements from

"When I approach political issues, I try t
both the heart of God and the truths of th

key groups that made him seem to be at least a more credible candidate for Evangelical interests than Clinton."

But Ray wasn't swayed.

"Jesus did not talk about abortion or gay marriage. What he did talk about was divorce, and this president is on his third wife," he said.

Though Trump made a case to evangelicals, he does not attend church regularly.

"He is not an active member," a representative from his Manhattan church told CNN.

Swartz cited a statistic about Trump supporters' church attendance.

"One very close study of Trump supporters in South Carolina during last year's primaries showed that the evangelicals who voted for him rarely attend church," he said.

LGBTQ rights have traditionally been another deal breaker between evangelicals and the Democratic Party. As I walked through the events of Ray's family life with him, he spoke proudly of his eleven children. He boasted about how his daughter, whom he adopted as a deaf and mentally disabled child, now holds two master's degrees.

"She came out as gay two years after I had started advocating for the LGBT community, so I didn't care, it didn't affect me, as I was a proponent of the community before her," he said.

I was surprised to hear this. But this is Ray's core message: there is overlap between Christian and liberal values. On his website, there is a picture of Ray in the old school design somewhere between the bright yellow backdrop and tightly aligned block text of Times New Roman. To his left is a picture of Jesus, and to his right is a picture of Franklin D. Roosevelt.

"Jesus brought the New Testament and Roosevelt brought the New Deal," Ray explained. "I connect the two, as I believe that Jesus was a man who wanted to help his neighbour, and that is the spirit of Roosevelt as well."

The idea of a progressive evangelical in some ways functions in a realm outside of the two party system. Jimmy Carter was perhaps, as Bruenig argued, our last public figure that could have identified himself as one.

Nevertheless, Swartz cited many examples of evangelicals engaging in political activism—on both sides of the political spectrum. Evangelicals denounced violence in Central America, protested apartheid in South Africa, and lobbied against the death penalty in the Supreme Court.

Most recently, Swartz continued, evangelicals "prayed for the unborn and for an agenda of justice and compassion for women and children that will create alternatives to the desperate, painful choice of abortion."

Progressive evangelicalism, Ray explained, sounds contradictory to some because the evangelical movement has been so publicly associated with conservative figures.

The connections Ray makes between social justice and Christianity contrast comments by those who would separate them. Adam Krok '19, who wrote an op-ed in the Yale Daily News titled "Godless Men at Yale," argues the two themes are incompatible.

"God is dead, and light and truth have replaced him," Krok wrote in that op-ed.

"To be liberally religious is a double bind," he said in an interview with The Politic. "You are most certainly not following the word of the Bible (which is racist, misogynistic, sexist and genocidal) and you are most certainly not treating others in a genuinely caring way, rather seeking to soothe your own belief in a liberal God than seeing people's innate kindness and goodness."

But Ray said that to identify evangelicalism exclusively with conservatism is to misunderstand its theology.

"Evangelicalism has got a whole new meaning that has little identity to what it actually is. My Christianity, my evangelicalism, refers to Jesus—in the teaching and example of Jesus," he said.

"Jesus himself was an extremely liberal man," he continued. "These conservative Christians are on a different tangent. Sometimes atheists are more like Christ than a conservative is."

Me'Lena Laudig '19 interprets Jesus' teachings in a similar way.

In an interview with The Politic, she described the "heart of God" as one "concerned about feeding the hungry, loving the hurting, aiding the oppressed, welcoming the refugee."

"When I approach political issues, I try to think about both the heart of God and the truths of the Bible. I don't have a one-size-fits-all framework for making political decisions and approach each one by contemplating the heart of Jesus and the truths that He teaches," she said.

Ryan Phipps, lead pastor at Forefront Church in Manhattan, also emphasized the importance of thinking outside of a one-size-fits-all framework.

"So much of what we deal with in this country, when it comes to this strange overlap of religion and politics, it's very unfortunate that we are always pigeon holed into thinking in binaries, when nothing about life or truth or faith or anything else in the world is binary," he said.

Ray has spent his life trying to move beyond this binary. As he drove away, I could just barely hear the recorded sermon blasting from the car. Meeting Ray made me wonder, in a time when the political divide is starker than ever, if it is constructive to think in dualities, and whether it is even possible to talk about religion in the same terms that distinguish Republicans from Democrats.

Ray Dubuque is the man who can, at times, be heard from afar, as well as the man who speaks so quietly that one has to lean in just to discern what he says. He is the man who furiously campaigns on sites titled CatholicArrogance and JesusWouldBeFurious.org, but sends thank you emails with the username RayOSun. He is, in his words, a liberal who likes Christ.

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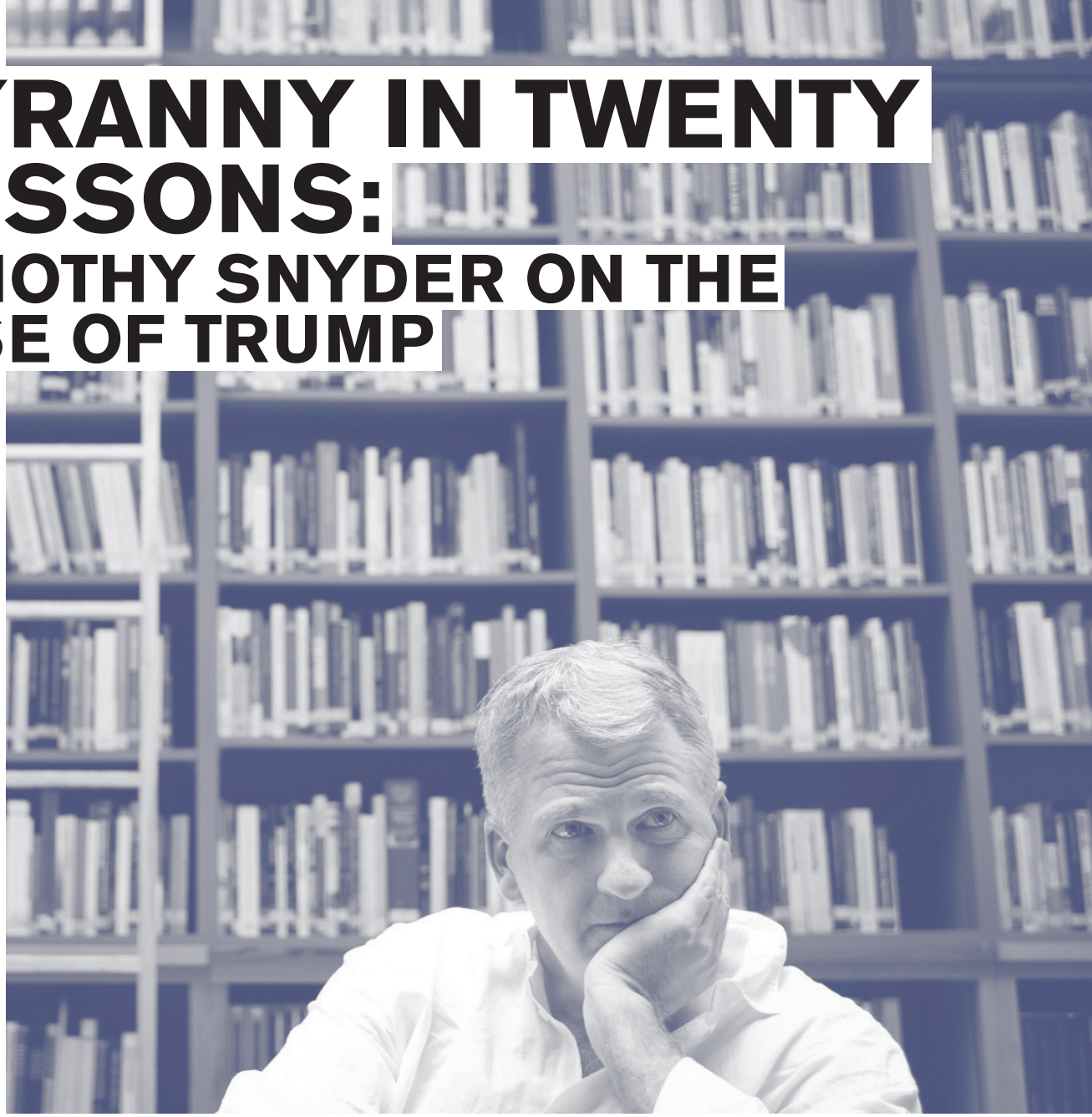
ne Bible"

TYRANNY IN TWENTY LESSONS:

TIMOTHY SNYDER ON THE RISE OF TRUMP

BY **AHMED ELBENNI**



EIGHT DAYS AFTER DONALD TRUMP WAS ELECTED PRESIDENT, Yale history professor Timothy Snyder posted an ominous warning on Facebook.

"Americans are no wiser than the Europeans who saw democracy yield to fascism, Nazism, or communism," he began. "Our one advantage is that we might learn from their experience. Now is a good time to do so. Here are twenty lessons from the twentieth century, adapted to the circumstances of today."

Within days the post had gone viral, accumulating over 17,000 shares on Facebook and making headlines across dozens of websites. The "20 Lessons from the 20th Century," as the post came to be called, focused a national spotlight on its author.

Even before his post, Snyder had been no stranger to fame. A distinguished historian of Eastern Europe, particularly of the rise of totalitarianism and the Holocaust, Snyder has long attracted adoration and criticism for his work. He has gathered numerous accolades, including an Andrew Carnegie Fellowship and Havel Foundation prize, and written several award-winning and bestselling books. Still, Snyder was surprised by the popular reaction to his post, from online hits to random hugs in New York City.

"I did not think when I wrote it that, within a few days, it would be the thing that I was best known for," Snyder said in an interview with *The Politic*.

"It's not a historical thing," said Snyder. "But I couldn't have done it without the 25 years of work [I spent] trying to understand history."

IN THE 1980S, WHEN SNYDER WAS studying history and political science at Brown University, communism collapsed in Europe. That shifting

political context pushed Snyder to think about intellectual and diplomatic history, two areas of study that would later define his professional career. After graduation, Snyder received a British Marshall Scholarship for history graduate work at Oxford. And yet, despite his extensive studies in the field, Snyder did not intend to become a historian. After all, his favorite subject in middle and high school was math. In college, he hoped instead that history would lay the foundation for a career in journalism or diplomacy. It wasn't until Snyder wrote his dissertation at Oxford that he decided to become a full-fledged historian.

By the time he arrived at Yale in 2001, Snyder already had a distinguished career. After receiving his doctorate from Oxford, Snyder served as an Academy Scholar at Harvard's Center for International Affairs until his move to Yale. In 2012, Yale appointed him Bird White Housum Professor of History.

As a historian of a region underrepresented in Yale's academic landscape, Snyder felt obligated to ensure that his students could learn from it. From that sense of responsibility emerged the two-part lecture course for which Snyder is best known at Yale: Eastern Europe to 1914 and Eastern Europe since 1914. The scope of the history covered in these two courses, beginning in the 800s and ending in the modern day, far exceeds Snyder's narrow academic focus on the rise of totalitarianism in twentieth century Eastern Europe.

Snyder had a monumental challenge before him: understanding the entirety of Eastern European history well enough to teach it.

"[It's] pretty much the hardest thing intellectually I've ever done," said Snyder, of crafting and teaching the class. "I try to make it look easy, but actually getting all the countries, all the empires, the themes [and] putting them into an order, follow a logic where the students can go from whatever they've got to confident knowledge, that's really hard."

Snyder credits the process of designing the course with making him a better historian — it forced him to read more of the historical literature and fill the gaps in his knowledge. He has been glad to see so many Yale students eager to learn about a region they previously knew nothing about. But ultimately Snyder's most satisfying experience as a professor was witnessing the course become something that "felt like a class to the students just as it felt like a class to [him]."

Yale students, for their part, love Snyder's lectures. His courses have become some of the history department's most popular, with consistently positive evaluations and rising enrollment. Students usually cite Snyder's engaging style and commanding presence to explain his success as a teacher. Zeshan Gondal '19 appreciated Snyder's use of humor and fearless tendency to "make self-deprecating jokes." Another student, Wesley Kocurek '19, found Snyder's willingness to "inject his personality into the course" refreshing.

"He kind of dumps information on you in the lectures, but it's fun [and] informative, and he obviously knows his stuff," Kocurek said. "You just get the sense that he's an extremely intelligent man who needs to speak quickly because that's how fast his thoughts are moving. It's almost like he's frustrated that we're not in his head."

Much of Snyder's work aims to get people to see what's in his head. Snyder believes an essential part of history is communicating a certain idea to people who don't already have it. Historical scholarship, in his view, exists to help people "understand a moment."

"I think [history] is both the science of trying to understand and the art of trying to convey"

"I think [history] is both the science of trying to understand and the art of trying to convey," Snyder said.

Snyder describes the first part of his approach to history as a chase to "trap the truth." His view of history as a series of moments suggests the historian's task is an impossible one, because each moment always gives way to the next. But through extensive research, historians can trap a moment. Once they have locked a moment into a place from which "it can't get out," they move on to what Snyder calls the "literary part": helping people understand what the historian already does.

This literary view has influenced how Snyder tells stories in his lectures and books to teach history. Many students have praised his storytelling style, which presents history not as a collection of facts but as a rich and complex chronicle. Through his storytelling, Snyder helps his students understand the past and how it clarifies the present.

"The present is like a river and the past are like stones that you can stand on," Snyder said. "It's good to have more stones, because everything is in flux all the time. You need ways to stand still and look around, and the past can help with that. I think this is a time when history does have something useful to say about the present, and I'm trying to do that."

For years, much of Snyder's focus was directed abroad. He had dedicated himself to drawing connections between Eastern Europe's past

1. do not obey in advance
2. defend an institution
3. recall professional ethics
4. when listening to politicians, distinguish certain words
5. be calm when the unthinkable arrives
6. be kind to our language
7. stand out
8. believe in truth
9. investigate
10. practice corporeal politics
11. make eye contact and small talk
12. take responsibility for the face of the world
13. hinder the one-party state
14. give regularly to good causes, if you can
15. establish a private life
16. learn from others in other countries
17. watch out for the paramilitaries
18. be reflective if you must be armed
19. be as courageous as you can
20. be a patriot

and its present. In 2015 he published Black Earth: The Holocaust as History and Warning and wrote articles warning against Vladimir Putin's rise. Then came Trump.

"PSYCHOLOGICALLY IT WAS THE first thing that I could do," Snyder said of his post after Trump's victory. "When things happen that you process as being devastating, the strongest temptation is to do nothing."

But in the days that followed the election, "I felt this weight on my chest that I had to get off. I write. So writing something was the first thing I could think to do," he said.

When Snyder drafted his now-famous "Twenty Lessons," he consulted his wife, fellow Yale professor Marci Shore. Shore also teaches Eastern European history, but covers it through intellectual and cultural trends.

The two met in 2002, while Shore was still a postdoctoral fellow at Columbia's Harriman Institute. Snyder was interested in writing about the Polish-Jewish Berman family in Warsaw, which she had researched in both Poland and Israel. In 2005, the two married in Cracow, Poland. While they don't collaborate on any projects, they do read each other's work.

"Usually Tim is impatient and wants to publish quickly, and I tend more often to be in favor of waiting, rereading, editing, contemplating the best venue," said Shore. "But in this case the urgency of the moment was such that I was, uncharacteristically, in favor of posting immediately."

Snyder agrees that he is impatient. By his own admission, everything seems to be moving very slowly, and he wishes "it would go more quickly."

Snyder feels that though the "world" may have felt he was rushing ahead – he published his post on November 15, only a week after Trump's election victory – from his perspective, he was behind. He wrote the twenty points quickly, and didn't wait long before submitting them to The New York Times, which turned his piece down. After consulting with Shore, he decided to publish in a public Facebook post, which he now sees as a "smart" move, since that allowed any news outlet to share it. The Dallas Morning News was the first, followed by In These Times, and then a flurry of sites ranging from The Huffington Post to the History News Network.

Not everyone has appreciated the speed with which Snyder has warned his listeners about the Trump presidency. Many accused Snyder of exaggerating Trump's threat and sounding the alarm bell too soon. But to Snyder, such criticism falls flat. He acknowledges that he may be wrong – he says he would be "delighted" if he were – but insists the stakes are too high to stay silent.

"If your choices in life are alarmism and authoritarianism, which one would you choose?" Snyder said. "If those are really the risks, then take your pick. Is [it] such a big deal to be made fun of a little? The other possibility is that your children and your grandchildren will grow up in a country that is not free."

Snyder dismisses alarmism charges because he feels they come from those who would prefer "to do nothing." Such claims, he argues, enable a dangerous complacency. One can insist that nothing about the world has changed, but such a fixation usually leads one to miss the subtle changes until it is too late.

"At any moment, any given

"If your choices in life are alarmism and authoritarianism, which one would you choose?"

second, [nothing is wrong]," said Snyder. "And then the next second is a little worse, the next second is a little worse, [but] you can always at each point say 'Don't be alarmist,' because not much has changed today or this hour. It's always easier to sit back and say 'This is normal,' then maybe get popcorn and watch Clint Eastwood movies. Anybody can do that."

To Snyder, the real difficulty lies in spurring action. In order to motivate people to act and not simply sit back, Snyder is willing to be mocked, and he is willing to be wrong. And as far as he is concerned, his warnings up until this point have been relatively moderate, even if many people don't see it that way.

"I'm more radical than most people," said Snyder. "But I'm less radical than everyday life."

SNYDER'S FOCUS ON AUTHORI-tarian threats to democracy crystallized during his trips to Eastern Europe throughout the 1990s. Those travels proved crucial for his intellectual development because these places – from Poland to Belarus to Ukraine – became "more real" to him.

"You can't write about places unless you feel intellectually and emotionally comfortable with [them]," he said.

Snyder's work focuses on places rather than on historical figures or ideological currents. Instead of writing about a nation, he observes how different nations and crimes have converged on a single place. The darkness of the places that Snyder ultimately chooses led a reviewer of one of his books to call him a "historian of evil."

And as a person who has spent his career studying the cruelest crimes humanity has ever perpetrated, Snyder has more than earned the label. His most famous book, Bloodlands, recounts the scale of human suffering inflicted on the lands between Nazi Germany and Soviet Russia with arresting details of mass starvation, familial cannibalism, and wholesale slaughter. Black Earth explores Ukraine as the site of the Holocaust's worst atrocities. Snyder acknowledges the challenges of writing about the annihilation of millions of lives, especially when the scale of the tragedy can obscure its human element.

"What I'm trying to do is get the reader to identify with people as individuals," says Snyder. "Even if I can't come close to doing the life justice, if I've made the person who died seem real, then that death is somehow registered in the reader, and then the reader can think about the numbers differently. A tragedy in which twelve people die is different from a tragedy in which 12,000 people die, but I don't think we can understand the 12,000 if we don't understand the twelve. And I don't think we can understand twelve unless we understand one."

Writing Bloodlands and Black Earth was not easy. But Snyder is ultimately pleased that he took care "not to dodge." He felt the subjects explored in his books were important ones, and that they were especially relevant to events unfolding today.

"I am glad that I took these things on," Snyder said. "Not because it's been pleasurable, but because I thought that those were the right things to be doing at the time."

To Shore, that clear moral compass represents one of Snyder's best qualities. She credits much of it to his mother, whom she describes as possessing an "unusually confident sense of moral clarity." According to Shore, Snyder's mother takes moral duty seriously, always considering the consequences of taking any moral maxim to its logical conclusion. Shore believes she and Snyder have internalized that emphasis on moral duty, especially as it pertains to their family.

"I think for both of us our children have added an additional moral weight to all our decisions," said Shore. "We're always thinking about them—and thinking about the question: what kind of world are we creating for our children?"

"I'm more radical than most people," said Snyder. "But I'm less radical than everyday life."

It is likely that sense of moral obligation that fueled Snyder's vocal denunciations of Trump and the Facebook post that has caught the attention of thousands. Through his writings, Snyder hopes to provide actionable guidelines for an American populace unfamiliar with the threat of totalitarianism that Trump represents.

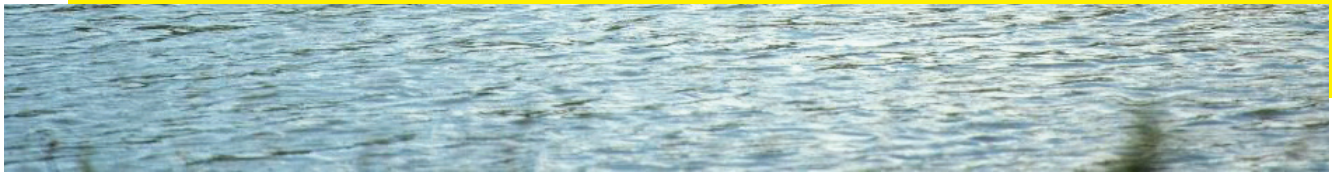
"You can't just act," said Snyder. "You need to have some sense of why you're acting. I'm trying to help the American republic get some standpoints from which it can understand its own realities."

Despite some of the criticism that he has received, Snyder is for the most part heartened by the reaction to his Facebook post. To him, it is evidence that Americans are looking for ways to take action, thus avoiding the complacency of which he is so critical. Meanwhile, Snyder is still not finished with the Facebook post. He has since expanded upon each of the twenty lessons, supplying them with historical examples and analysis, and compiled his additions into a single book named On Tyranny, to be published on February 28.

"I'm gratified," said Snyder, of the excitement that has surrounded his twenty lessons. Then, he added with a smile, "And I'll take all the random hugs in New York too."

Zoo Gone Wild: After Escobar, Colombia Faces His Hippos

BY **RAHUL NAGVEKAR**



Photos courtesy of **Parque Temático Hacienda Nápoles**

THE PUBLIC WAS OUTRAGED by the pictures of fifteen uniformed men standing beside Pepe the Hippo's body. The most vocal protesters demanded that the Minister of Environment resign. Newspapers ran angry letters from readers, and the outcry soon led a judge to prohibit further hippo killings.

The common hippopotamus is classified as 'vulnerable' by the International Union for Conservation of Nature, with the species' numbers threatened in part by hunting for their meat and ivory teeth. But Pepe was not shot by poachers. His death in June 2009 was sanctioned by environmental authorities–in Colombia.

Hippos are native to Africa, not South America. Pepe was in Colombia as one of nearly 60 wild hippos living around Hacienda Nápoles, a ranch southeast of Medellín. Some of the hippos have already made it to the nearby Magdalena River, with a few sighted more than 150 miles away.

These hippos of Colombia are larger than any other wild animals on the continent and are reproducing faster than their African counterparts. They threaten the local wildlife–and nearby humans. But they would never have been in Colombia if not for the drug lord Pablo Escobar.

From his base in Medellín, Escobar ran a criminal organization that, at its peak in the 1980s, was estimated to have reaped $400 million each week. According to his accountant, Escobar was handling so much cash that he spent $2,500 each month on rubber bands to hold together the bills.

The Medellín Cartel was the main supplier of smuggled cocaine to the United States. Using the strategy of plata o plomo (loosely, money or bullets), it won enormous influence within the country. The cartel bought politicians and the police–when Escobar was eventually captured, he was housed in a luxurious prison with a jacuzzi, from which he later escaped.

But through a campaign of terror, his enemies paid dearly. Escobar was reportedly behind a 1985 siege of the Colombian Supreme Court, the assassination of the frontrunner in the country's 1990 presidential election, and, as part of a failed attempt to kill that vote's eventual winner, an airplane bombing that killed 110.

Escobar also accumulated extraordinary personal wealth, with Forbes listing him as a billionaire in each of the last seven years of his life. In 1989, the magazine named him the world's seventh-richest person, and some estimates placed his net worth at $30 billion. Escobar used his fortune to fund schools and hospitals, winning admiration from many Colombians. But he also funded extravagant projects like his ranch–Hacienda Nápoles–which he kept stocked with elephants, rhinos, ostriches, giraffes, and hippos.

Carlos Valderrama, a veterinarian with the charity Webconserva who has worked with the descendants of Escobar's hippos, told *The Politic* about the animals' murky origins.

"If you want to trust the documentation from the time," Valderrama cautioned, "[Escobar] brought three pairs of hippos from different zoos in the U.S. But–because you never know with Pablo Escobar–people say he really brought three females and one male directly from Africa."

In either case, along with dinosaur statues, tanks, and cocaine-smuggling planes, the hippos were among the attractions locals enjoyed for years at Hacienda Nápoles, free of charge. But when Escobar was killed in 1993 after a massive manhunt, the ranch was confiscated.

"Most of the animals were taken to different zoos," Valderrama told *The Politic*. "But the hippos, most of them stayed at Hacienda Nápoles and reproduced freely, until, back in 2007, we got word that some very strange creatures were seen in a nearby town called Puerto Olaya."

At Hacienda Nápoles, the hippos lived within a lake–but the ranch's simple livestock fences never guaranteed that the animals, which can weigh over four tons, would stay in.

As David Echeverri, a biologist with the local environmental authority Cornare, explained in an interview with *The Politic*, "The hippos took over the lake and made it their own. It offered everything they needed–food, security, and calm. They just didn't know that they had the whole Magdalena Medio valley at their disposal."

And it was only a matter of time before they found out. Male hippos are fiercely protective of their mates and waters, and with one dominant bull, nicknamed El Viejo, monopolizing Hacienda Nápoles, younger males had to choose between remaining subservient or moving out.

Several male hippos, including Pepe, chose the second option–making what seems like the right decision.

"This area and its environment is almost like a hippo paradise," said Michael Knight, a South African ecologist who has advised Colombia's Ministry of Environment on hippo population control, in an interview with *The Politic*. "It's this manna from heaven, if you think about the hippos," he observed.

Valderrama said, "They don't have predators here. And most of the hippo

populations in Africa are controlled by drought–many of the animals die naturally because of the dryness and the lack of food and water."

But since drought occurs far less frequently in Colombia, there are effectively no controls on the hippos' reproduction.

No one is quite sure what effect that will have on Colombia's river environments. But all of the biologists interviewed by *The Politic* noted that given their size and behavior, the hippos are bound to affect local habitats, wildlife, and people.

Jonathan Shurin, a University of California, San Diego professor currently studying the Colombian hippos' ecological impact, told *The Politic* that hippos in Africa are sometimes called ecosystem engineers.

"They're sort of amphibious, they come out at night and walk around and feed on plants on land, and then they go back into the water and just poop a lot of nutrients into the water," Shurin said. "They fertilize things, they disturb the bottom. That has a huge effect on all sorts of aquatic and terrestrial organisms."

Valderrama and Echeverri expressed concern about whether an unchecked hippo population would displace Colombia's manatees, caimans, and otters.

And along with Knight, all three noted that wild hippos in Colombia posed a significant risk to humans.

"In Africa, hippos and puff adders account for the most fatalities when it comes to dealing with wildlife. So hippos are up there, and they're dangerous," Knight said.

Valderrama described a few "mock attacks" in which Colombian fishermen were chased by hippos. As far as he knows, no hippos in the area have killed or seriously injured anyone. There have, however, been reports of damage to crops and livestock by hippos, including by Pepe, who killed at least six calves.

Between this property damage and his attempts to attack fishermen, Pepe was deemed a threat to local residents. Still, Valderrama insists every effort was made to avoid his culling.

"We searched for a place to relocate him for over two years," Valderrama told *The Politic*. "We tracked the hippo, we followed him, we baited him, we did the most we could to find a new location for this hippo. And after two years, we decided that he was too dangerous for the community, and culling was the only option."

Animal rights groups disagreed. "It is an outrage that the same government that allows the torture of bullfighting and cockfighting is now endorsing the murder of hippopotamuses," activist Marcela Ramirez, who led a pro-hippo demonstration in Bogotá, told the Los Angeles Times.

The uproar forced the Ministry of Environment to cancel plans to cull Pepe's mate and calf. Knight and his South African colleague Peter Morkel were flown in to help devise a humane alternative for controlling Colombia's hippo population.

Knight himself takes a dim view of arguments that the Colombian hippos deserve protection.

"Why would you want to be propagating a potentially alien invasive species that's very dangerous?" Knight asked. "You have to ask from a biodiversity conservation perspective, what objective is this fulfilling? Nothing more than a zoo."

Knight warned, "If it's a zoo, you have to contain them. It's fine if you want to contain them, but then you have to actually manage their reproduction."

Which is harder than it sounds. Knight and Valderrama agree that Hacienda Nápoles, which now includes a theme park, is probably the best permanent home for Colombia's hippos. And they are both certain that keeping males and females in separate lakes on the ranch is not an option.

"When they are in season," Valderrama explained, "the males will try anything to get where the females are, and with one escaped male among the females, that's enough to get them pregnant. So that's not very secure."

Consequently, all of the male hippos will either have to be culled–unlikely, given that option's unpopularity–or castrated.

But these are not tame animals, and the procedure can be dangerous for the people involved.

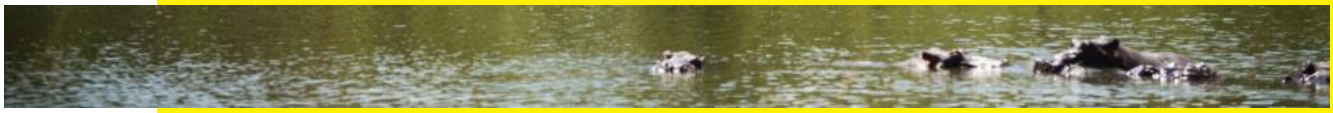
"You have to ask from a biodiversity conservation perspective, what objective is this fulfilling? Nothing more than a zoo."

According to Valderrama, anesthetizing adult hippos is near impossible due to their size and fat content. Hippo castration then requires invasive surgery that the animal might not survive, due to the chance of infection. And it is not cheap.

"We successfully carried out the first castration of a hippo in the wild," Valderrama told *The Politic*. "We captured the animal outside of Hacienda Nápoles, castrated it, and took it back. It cost us about $50,000."

In their 2009 report on Colombian hippo control, Knight and Morkel outlined an elaborate plan to enclose the hippos around their lake at Hacienda Nápoles, then draw them into mobile steel pens where they could be anesthetized and the males identified and castrated.

The plan is estimated to cost at least $100,000, and would require an electric fence to keep the hippos from leaving Hacienda Nápoles. "All escaped animals from the sanctuary," the report reads, "should be eliminated."



“This area and its environment is almost like a hippo paradise.”

Valderrama confirmed with *The Politic* that the report’s recommendations have not yet been implemented. If they are, they are likely to face some pushback.

“Of course, people who have been affected by the hippos don’t want them around,” Valderrama said. “But people in the region–I’d say that half of the people agree with the control and half of them don’t want it, because they like having the hippos.”

It appears that some local residents have even cared for orphaned young hippos from Hacienda Nápoles in their homes, with one farmer telling Fusion, “It’s just like raising a dog. They even follow you when you call them by their name.”

Echeverri understands why people might be attached to the hippos. “They’re charismatic enough,” he said, “and they draw tourists to the area.”

Still, he argued that when allocating conservation resources, native Colombian species like jaguars and pumas ought to take precedence over the hippos.

Valderrama concurred. “To be honest, I don’t want them to be sacrificed,” he said. “But the option to do nothing is really the worst option. Because we have an active, growing population of an exotic species that can harm our wildlife and people in Colombia–that’s something that can be prevented right now, and it’s our responsibility to prevent it.”

For their part, environmental authorities are enticing the hippos to stay at Hacienda Nápoles with food like carrots and alfalfa, and they have been able to capture and sterilize some of the younger stragglers.

On a hopeful note, Valderrama remarked, “If we can find a place that will be willing to receive the animals, and maybe fund the relocations, then maybe we can solve this situation before it gets to the point of no return.”

But until then, in a country still healing from Pablo Escobar’s violence and destruction, a rapidly expanding population of hippos reminds us that the kingpin’s legacy will not easily be erased.

IN HER CORNER

Connecticut Senators Back McMahon

BY **BRIANA BURROUGHS**

SENATORS RICHARD BLUMENTHAL- LAW '73 (D-CT) and Chris Murphy (D-CT) were not "ready to rumble" with Linda McMahon again. In her two runs for Connecticut's Senate seats McMahon, a Republican and former World Wrestling Entertainment (WWE) CEO, lost each time by over ten percentage points — first to Blumenthal in 2010, then to Murphy in 2012. This year, it seemed like McMahon finally had the upper hand.

After one hundred million dollars of campaign spending by McMahon, several ads questioning Blumenthal's Vietnam service record, and a barrage of accusations that Murphy did not attend critical hearings and votes on the financial crisis, the three shuffled into a room of reporters, supporters, and donors — as a team. Their aim was to ensure McMahon's confirmation as the next Administrator of the Small Business Administration (SBA).

Brutal ads about unfair tax breaks, mistreatment of employees, drug scandals, and layoffs during her time at the WWE haunted McMahon during her two failed campaigns. But she sat comfortably beside the two Democrats who defeated her as they praised her business experience, moderate views, and commitment to women and veteran-owned businesses. During fierce Democratic resistance to President Donald Trump's Cabinet nominees, why did Republican Linda McMahon receive glowing endorsements from her two former opponents?

Since 2012, McMahon has dedicated much of her time to philanthropic work. She launched a "Women Can Have It All" speaker series at Sacred Heart University in 2014, focusing on the experiences of women in the workplace. In 2016, McMahon co-founded Women Leadership Live, a startup that promotes leadership opportunities for women.

Several state Democratic officials mentioned in interviews with *The Politic* that McMahon has not played a visible role in Connecticut politics since her loss to Murphy in 2012. But Federal Election Commission (FEC) records show that she has donated regularly to the Leadership Connecticut Political Action Committee (PAC) and the Connecticut Republican Party. A veteran campaigner familiar with Republican politics in Connecticut told *The Politic* that McMahon has also continued to informally advise Republican candidates after her two campaigns.

McMahon's SBA nomination received official endorsements from Senators Blumenthal and Murphy. Representatives of the all Democratic Connecticut congressional delegation also expressed support for McMahon's nomination.

"Growing our economy and promoting job creation are top priorities for the folks I represent in Congress. I'm looking forward to working with Administrator McMahon to support Connecticut's small businesses and achieve our shared goals for the people of this wonderful state, whom we are both proud to serve," said Representative Elizabeth Esty (CT-5) in an email to *The Politic*.

Other comments from Connecticut lawmakers were similarly hopeful about collaboration, but lacking in details. Representative Jim Himes' (CT-4) comment to *The Politic* compared McMahon to other Cabinet nominees.

"Linda McMahon is one of the few Trump selections for his Cabinet that actually has relevant experience in the field for which she was nominated," he said.

This reference to relevant experience appeared in interviews across party lines. In an interview with *The Politic*, J. R. Romano, Chairman of the Connecticut Republican Party, explained that McMahon's successful tenure at the WWE in Connecticut's stifling small business environment will serve as important experience during her time at the SBA.

"She's certainly qualified. She built a small business into an empire. The credentials are there," Romano said.

After lauding McMahon's commitment to the Connecticut Republican Party after her 2012 Senate campaign, Romano added, "McMahon witnessed first hand what not to do in Connecticut."

Governor Dannel Malloy received criticism after General Electric announced it was closing its headquarters in Connecticut, citing the state's high tax rates. The CNBC "America's Top States for Business" scorecard ranked Connecticut as the 43rd best state for business in 2016. Another recent survey by Thumbtack ranked Connecticut as the worst state for small business in America.

Representative John Larson (CT-1) supported McMahon immediately after her nomination. At the time of publication, only Representatives Rosa DeLauro (CT-3) and Joe Courtney (CT-2) had yet to comment. A source close to a Connecticut Representative explained to *The Politic* that Democratic officeholders are unlikely to criticize McMahon before she implements new policy. However, the source confirmed that these positive statements may not

(fig. 1)

continue throughout her term.

According to Gary Rose, the department chair of Government, Politics, and Global Studies at Sacred Heart University, there is a strategy behind the Connecticut delegation's praise.

"I'm sure that Murphy and Blumenthal know that it is relevant to their own political fortune to have businesses getting loans from the SBA here in Connecticut," Rose told *The Politic*. "I think once they realized [McMahon] was probably going to be confirmed, they got on board with that because she can certainly help businesses here in Connecticut. If they can take some credit for that, then that's a win-win for everybody."

In his introduction at McMahon's confirmation hearing, Senator Blumenthal remarked on his and McMahon's shared loyalty to Connecticut.

"I hope [McMahon] will continue to have Connecticut at the top of her mind as she assumes this new role," he said.

In response, Senator James Risch (R-ID), Chairman of the Senate Committee on Small Business and Entrepreneurship, joked that he hoped McMahon would keep Idaho at the top of her mind. According to two journalists familiar with McMahon's political career and the role of past SBA directors, this remark is indicative of a larger trend of support for SBA Administrators from their home states' delegations. One journalist remarked that confirming a Republican Administrator from Connecticut would be more helpful to the state than confirming a Democrat from any other state.

McMahon has faced scrutiny for her political donations. Before her nomination to head the SBA, McMahon donated nearly 7.5 million dollars to PACs supporting Donald Trump's presidential bid, according to FEC records. McMahon's office declined to comment when contacted about the alleged relationship between her PAC donations and the nomination following her confirmation. Senators present at McMahon's confirmation hearing did not mention her donation history.

McMahon is an annual donor to the Republican National Committee and National Republican Congressional Committee. Between 2013 and 2016, McMahon donated to the campaigns of 26 Republican senators who voted to confirm her on February 14. (Figure 1)

Six years after defeating McMahon, Blumenthal ran for reelection in 2016 against Republican candidate Dan Carter. McMahon and her husband donated $2,700 each to Carter's principal campaign committee, but neither acted as a high profile surrogate for Carter nor disparaged Blumenthal publicly. Carter later lost the election to Blumenthal by nearly 30 points.

In 2012, former President Barack Obama elevated the SBA to a Cabinet-level agency. The SBA Administrator also held a Cabinet position in the Bill Clinton LAW '73 administration, but former President George W. Bush '68 chose not to include the SBA Administrator in his Cabinet. Since the SBA's formation in 1953, confirmation hearings and votes have remained largely uncontroversial and bipartisan.

Both Karen Mills, a former private equity firm president and chair of Maine's Council on Competitiveness and the Economy, and Maria Contreras-Sweet, a former bank executive and Secretary of the California Business, Transportation and Housing Agency, served as SBA Administrators under President Obama. The Senate confirmed Mills unanimously in April 2009 and confirmed Contreras-Sweet by a simple voice vote in March 2014.

Senators' increased attendance at the confirmation hearings of President Trump's Cabinet nominees reflects pressure from the media and constituents to get their elected officials' opinions of President Trump's

"Hyper partisanship is to blame for the lack of full support for McMahon from Democrats"

nominees and their policies on record. Contreras-Sweet's confirmation hearing featured only seven out of 18 senators on the Small Business and Entrepreneurship Committee at the time. Mills' hearing included six out of 19 senators. In a clear departure from that pattern, 18 of 19 senators participated in questioning McMahon.

Former President Obama nominated Karen Mills to head the SBA in 2009. Two Republican senators from Mills' state of residence, Maine, introduced her, a Democrat nominee for a Democratic administration. Senators Susan Collins and Olympia Snowe (R-ME) cited Mills' ties to Maine and her experience with the local business community as evidence of Mills' readiness. The choice to be vocally bipartisan in the name of state allegiance mirrors the actions of Senators Blumenthal and Murphy.

According to FEC records, Mills donated over $30,000 to the Obama Victory Fund and Obama for America in 2008, before her appointment. She also donated to Senator Mitch McConnell (R-KY)'s campaign that same year. Mills and her husband donated equal amounts to the campaigns of Senator Collins and her opponent, Thomas Allen, in Maine's 2008 Senate election. Before that election, however, the Mills contributed significantly to Allen's congressional campaigns. While they did donate to Senator Collins' opponent, they have neither run for public office themselves nor have they publicly disparaged Senator Collins.

In contrast, Contreras-Sweet has contributed only $3,500 to date, according to the FEC. Contreras-Sweet's hearing began with statements of support from the two Democratic senators from her home state of California, Senator Dianne Feinstein (D-CA) and former Senator Barbara Boxer (D-CA). Contreras-Sweet had not run for public office before her nomination.

On Tuesday, February 14, the Senate confirmed Linda McMahon to become the Administrator of the Small Business Administration by a 81-19 vote. Democratic senators accounted for all 19 votes against McMahon's confirmation.

Sean Cleary, a former Congressional District Field Director for McMahon's 2012 Senate campaign and the current political director of Republican Peter Lumaj's 2018 Statewide Exploratory Committee, reflected on McMahon's confirmation vote in an interview with *The Politic*.

"Republicans voiced bipartisan support for former President Obama's SBA picks. The fact that 19 Democrats opposed Linda McMahon, who has done more business roundtables and talked to more small business owners than anyone in the Northeast in the last ten years, says a lot," said Cleary. "It seems like those Democrats [who voted against McMahon] would rather play politics than help jumpstart the economy."

While Leigh Appleby, Communications Director for the Connecticut Democratic Party, expressed concern that the majority of President Trump's appointments are his wealthy personal friends, she told The Politic, "Senators Blumenthal and Murphy deserve a lot of credit for putting politics aside and supporting Linda McMahon's nomination."

Senator Sherrod Brown (D-OH) echoed Appleby's concerns about President Trump appointments. In his statement to The Politic, Senator Brown accused McMahon and the WWE of shortchanging and mistreating workers. Senator Chris Van Hollen (D-MD) expressed similar concern in a public statement, writing that the SBA "does not need a leader who will advance profits at workers' expense."

But Rose believes that hyper partisanship is to blame for the lack of full support for McMahon from Democrats.

"There are some Democrats in Washington, D.C. right now, just as there were some Republicans during Obama's administration, who will oppose virtually every decision of Donald Trump," he said. "And so it doesn't surprise me at all that even somebody like Linda McMahon would be opposed by some Democrats, simply because she is Trump's nominee. It probably has nothing to do with her at all. But it has everything to do with their animus towards Donald Trump."

McMahon's confirmation shows both the limits of bipartisanship in today's political climate and the way in which representatives of one state can work together across party lines. While Democratic support for McMahon will most likely fade, Connecticut's Senators are putting their state before party.

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